

Measuring National Identity with Conjoint Experiments Using the Case of Taiwan

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Abstract

How should scholars measure national identity? Conventional survey batteries, such as the International Social Survey Programme’s National Identity module, ask respondents to rate identity attributes independently, producing ceiling effects and giving researchers no information about how respondents weigh competing criteria against one another. We propose choice-based conjoint experiments as an alternative. Using original survey data from Taiwan ($n = 2,050$), we field two conjoint experiments: a binary design replicating the ISSP battery, and a multi-level design with nine Taiwan-specific attributes. Across both designs, respondents trade off ascriptive, civic, and voluntarist criteria, a structure that standard batteries cannot register. First, despite intense polarization over the categorical labels Taiwanese citizens choose for themselves, the substantive content respondents endorse is highly consensual: voluntarist and civic markers (feeling Taiwanese, supporting democracy, civic engagement) carry more weight than ascriptive markers across subgroups. Second, voluntarist and civic levels carry enough weight that profiles starting from a “low” ascriptive baseline (non-Han ancestry, Mainland China origin) are still chosen at rates at or above parity when those levels are present. The contest over identity labels in Taiwan masks a wide consensus on the civic and voluntarist content of national membership.

Keywords: national identity, conjoint analysis, Taiwan, survey methodology, nationalism

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I Introduction

National identity is among the most consequential political phenomena of the modern era. It shapes the boundaries of political community, structures claims to sovereignty, and mediates the relationship between citizens and the state (Anderson, 1983; Gellner, 1983; Smith, 1991). Despite its centrality to political life, the measurement of the content of national identity in survey research remains relatively simple. The dominant approach, exemplified by the International Social Survey Programme’s (ISSP) National Identity modules fielded in 1995, 2003, 2013, and 2023, asks respondents to rate a series of attributes (ancestry, birthplace, language, and so on) independently on importance scales (ISSP Research Group, 1998, 2012, 2015, 2026). This item-by-item measurement strategy has generated a sustained comparative literature on national identity (Kunovich, 2009; Jones and Smith, 2001; Shulman, 2002; Reeskens and Hooghe, 2010; Larsen, 2017), but it suffers from two fundamental limitations.

First, independent rating scales produce ceiling effects. When respondents evaluate criteria one at a time, many if not most attributes receive high importance ratings, compressing the distribution and obscuring meaningful variation. If large majorities rate both ancestry and democratic participation as “very important” for national membership, researchers learn little about the relative priority respondents assign to these very different criteria. Second, and more fundamentally, item-by-item batteries cannot identify trade-offs. National identity is widely understood as a multidimensional concept, a bundle of ascriptive, civic, and voluntarist criteria that people weigh differently (Kohn, 1944; Brubaker, 1992; Shulman, 2004; Bonikowski and DiMaggio, 2016). Yet the conventional measurement approach treats each dimension as separable, providing no information about how respondents adjudicate when identity criteria conflict.

This paper proposes conjoint experiments as an alternative strategy for measuring national identity. Conjoint analysis, increasingly common in political science for studying multidimensional preferences (Hainmueller, Hopkins and Yamamoto, 2014; Bansak et al., 2021), asks respondents to evaluate profiles that bundle multiple attributes simultaneously. By forcing respondents to make choices among profiles that vary across several identity dimensions at once, conjoint designs estimate the relative weight respondents place on each attribute level, including the trade-offs between them. The approach yields valid causal estimates of the marginal effect of each identity criterion on perceptions of national belonging

(Hainmueller, Hopkins and Yamamoto, 2014; Leeper, Hobolt and Tilley, 2020) and also likely mitigates social desirability bias that may affect responses to direct identity questions (Horiuchi, Markovich and Yamamoto, 2022).

We demonstrate this strategy using original survey data from Taiwan ($n = 2,050$). Taiwan is a particularly well-suited case for the conjoint approach. As an outcome case in the sense of Gerring and Cojocaru (2016), it exhibits extreme values on the variable of interest. Exclusive Taiwanese identification has risen from roughly 18% to over 60% of the population in the past three decades, while Chinese identification has declined to single digits (Election Study Center, National Chengchi University, 2024), a shift inseparable from Taiwan’s democratization (Wachman, 1994; Rigger, 2011). National identity has become, in the words of Achen and Wang (2017, p. 276), “the single most important political cleavage on the island.” The same conditions also produce the trade-offs between ascriptive, civic, and voluntarist criteria that we are best positioned to estimate with a forced-choice format (Ho, 2022; Chen, 2013).

We field two choice-based conjoint experiments on the same nationally representative sample. The first (CBC #1) is a simple binary design that replicates the content of the ISSP National Identity battery in a conjoint format. While the battery asks respondents to rate each attribute independently, the conjoint forces trade-offs among the same criteria. The second (CBC #2) is a more complex multi-level design with nine Taiwan-specific attributes. The second, more context-sensitive design exploits the conjoint format’s capacity for multi-level attribute variation to operationalize identity in greater detail.

We report two arguably novel insights about Taiwanese identity. First, democratic commitment functions as a central criterion for national membership and can carry an individual into the political community even where ascriptive markers run the other way, a finding consistent with long-standing theoretical claims about the civic core of nationalism (Greenfeld, 1992; Linz and Stepan, 1996; Nodia, 1992). Second, the content of national identity in Taiwan is more consensual than the contested categorical labels (Taiwanese, Chinese, both) suggest. The contest over identity *labels* in Taiwan, intense as it is, masks a wide consensus on the civic and voluntarist content of national membership.

The remainder of the paper proceeds in five sections. Section 2 sets out the multidimensional structure of national identity and the limits of conventional measurement. Section 3 introduces Taiwan as

the case. Section 4 details the research design and estimation strategy. Section 5 reports the main and subgroup results, and section 6 discusses implications and limitations.

2 National Identity as a Multidimensional Concept

Dimensions of National Identity

The scholarly study of national identity has long recognized its multidimensional character. Kohn (1944) introduced the foundational distinction between civic nationalism, rooted in individual choice, law, and rational association, and ethnic nationalism, grounded in descent, language, and cultural community. While subsequent scholars have complicated and criticized the dichotomy as overly rigid (Brubaker, 1992, 1996; Calhoun, 1993; Mylonas and Tudor, 2023), the underlying insight that national identity comprises analytically distinct types of criteria has remained central to the field.

Smith (1991) identified five elements of national identity, including a historic territory, common myths and historical memories, a mass public culture, common legal rights and duties, and a common economy (see also Connor, 1994, on the ethnic dimension). Shulman (2002) proposed a tripartite classification of civic, ethnic, and cultural dimensions that maps empirical variation more accurately than the binary civic/ethnic framework. Habermas (1996) argued that, in mature democracies, national identification can be anchored in commitment to constitutional and democratic principles, which he termed “constitutional patriotism,” so that support for democratic institutions can function as a marker of belonging in its own right. Bonikowski and DiMaggio (2016), treating identity as a measurable variable with specifiable content (after Abdelal et al., 2006), identified four “varieties” of American nationalism, and comparative work shows that the empirical clustering of identity items is not stable across countries (Kunovich, 2009; Theiss-Morse, 2009; Reeskens and Hooghe, 2010; Larsen, 2017; Dawkins and Hanson, 2022).

For the purposes of measurement, we follow Shulman (2002) and Wright, Citrin and Wand (2012) in distinguishing three broad types of identity criteria. *Ascriptive* criteria are those a person is born with or into (ancestry, ethnicity, birthplace, native language). *Civic* criteria concern formal membership in the political community (citizenship, residence, observance of the political system as an obligation of

membership). *Voluntarist* criteria reflect subjective identification and active commitment to the national community, including support for the political project that defines it (see Kymlicka, 2001, on voluntarist conceptions). The boundary between civic and voluntarist is fluid in practice. Items about respect for political institutions can read either as a formal-membership obligation, in which case they are civic, or as an expression of active commitment to the political project of the nation, in which case they are voluntarist. Which reading prevails is an empirical question for any given country, and we treat it as such for Taiwan via factor analysis (see Appendix ?? of the Supplementary Information, hereafter “SI”). The key theoretical point is that these dimensions are not merely additive. People weigh them differently, and the relative weight assigned to each indicates the *kind* of national identity a person holds.

Limitations of Existing Measurement Approaches

The ISSP National Identity module, the main survey instrument since 1995, asks respondents to rate a series of attributes on a four-point scale from “very important” to “not important at all” for being truly [NATIONALITY]. This approach has three limitations. First, it produces *ceiling effects*. Social desirability and acquiescence bias push most ratings into the top two categories, leaving researchers with truncated distributions (Krosnick, 1991; Sniderman and Grob, 1996). Second, the battery provides *no information about trade-offs*. If a respondent rates both ancestry and democratic participation as “very important,” the researcher cannot determine which criterion would win under forced choice. Theories of national identity are fundamentally about the *relative* weight of criteria (Kohn, 1944; Brubaker, 1992), and a measurement instrument that cannot estimate relative weights cannot adjudicate among them. Third, the item-by-item format treats national identity as *decomposable* into independent dimensions, when the weight placed on one criterion is meaningfully related to the weight placed on others.

The Conjoint Solution

Conjoint analysis addresses each of the limitations identified. Developed in marketing research and formalized for causal inference in political science by Hainmueller, Hopkins and Yamamoto (2014), choice-based conjoint experiments present respondents with sets of profiles that vary randomly across multi-

ple attributes and require them to choose between profiles. Because attribute levels are randomized, the marginal effect of each attribute level on the probability of selection, the average marginal component effect (AMCE), is identified nonparametrically.

Applied to national identity, the design presents respondents with hypothetical individuals whose identity-relevant attributes vary randomly across tasks. The substantive innovation is the forced-choice format. Respondents must trade attributes off against one another, and that design feature lets us estimate the *relative* weight respondents assign to each criterion. Three advantages follow. First, the choice format *eliminates ceiling effects*, because respondents cannot rate everything as important. They must discriminate. Second, it *forces trade-offs*, and the AMCE for each attribute estimates its marginal contribution to selection *holding other attributes constant*. Third, the presentation of complete profiles preserves the *multidimensional* character of national identity in the measurement instrument itself, treating identity as a structured combination of content and contestation (Abdelal et al., 2006). The forced-choice format also approximates how citizens actually evaluate national belonging in everyday life, where a person presents as a full bundle of characteristics rather than as criteria to be rated one by one. Horiuchi, Markovich and Yamamoto (2022) additionally show that the multi-attribute structure mitigates social desirability bias for sensitive criteria, since it is less transparent which attribute is being “tested.”

Marginal means complement AMCEs as a second quantity of interest. Unlike AMCEs, which are inherently relative to a reference category, marginal means estimate the absolute probability that a profile possessing a given attribute level is chosen, averaged over all other attributes (Leeper, Hobolt and Tilley, 2020). They are particularly useful for subgroup comparisons, where differences in marginal means estimate the extent to which a given attribute level is valued differently by different types of respondents.

3 The Case of Taiwan

Research on Taiwanese national identity has converged on three salient features that our conjoint design is well placed to investigate. Taiwanese identity is widely argued to have become increasingly civic, support for democracy is held up as a central criterion for national belonging, and the question of identity

is the primary axis of political contestation on the island. Each claim has solid qualitative and observational support. Each also leaves an open empirical question that conventional rating-scale instruments are poorly equipped to answer.

A brief historical recap sets the stakes. The idea of a Taiwanese political community distinct from both China and the Japanese colonizers first emerged under Japanese colonization (1895–1945) (Ho, 2022; Tu, 1996). After the Chinese Civil War, the Kuomintang (KMT) relocated the Republic of China (ROC) to the island in 1949 and ruled under a one-party regime that imposed a pan-ethnic Chinese identity and converted much of the upwardly mobile middle class into Mandarin speakers and Chinese nationalists (Yang, 2007). Taiwanese identity nonetheless lingered, eventually driving the opposition movement that led to the end of martial law in 1987 and the first direct presidential elections in 1996 (Wachman, 1994). During the early years of democratization, the identity split between “Taiwanese” and “Chinese” identifiers tracked the sub-ethnic split between *benshengren* (descendants of Hoklo and Hakka settlers) and *waishengren* (mainlanders who arrived with the KMT). Electoral politics led the Democratic Progressive Party (DPP) to mobilize voters with appeals to Taiwanese identity, while also incentivizing political actors to widen the appeal across (sub-)ethnic cleavages with calls for a “collectivity of common fate” (Wang and Liu, 2004, p. 572). The pan-ethnic, ascriptive narrative imposed by the KMT and advanced by Mainland China gave the Taiwanese-identity project a further reason to define the political community on grounds other than Chinese ethnicity (Cabestan, 2005; Simon, 2007).

Civicness

The first claim is that Taiwanese national identity has become less ethnic and more civic. Qualitative scholarship has long argued so (Song, 2009; Wong, 2001). Survey research provides partial support. Citizens across backgrounds and identity labels increasingly distinguish their political identification as Taiwanese citizens from their cultural-ethnic identity (Wang and Liu, 2004). The fit between objective sub-ethnic origin and self-chosen identity has loosened (Shen and Wu, 2008), and the primordial dimension of survey indicators has become less reliable (Chen, 2012). A 2014 probability survey found that fewer than 8% defined Taiwanese-ness by “common blood,” while 39% emphasized cultural identification and

45% emphasized “living and working” in Taiwan (Zhong, 2016). The picture is not uniform. Taiwanese identity politics has at times veered toward the ethnic-based exclusion of mainlanders (Cabestan, 2005), and immigrants from Mainland China and Southeast Asia continue to face suspicion (Kao and Liu, 2025; Rich et al., 2022). The open question is how far Taiwanese respondents have actually moved away from ascriptive criteria, and at what relative weight those criteria now sit alongside civic and voluntarist ones.

Democracy

The second claim is that support for democracy looms large among non-ascriptive criteria. Democratization is described as “the most important shared living experience” of the island’s population (Wang and Liu, 2004, p. 571). Kaeding (2011) extends the argument to the framing of citizenship more generally. Empirical support is uneven. Existing studies report positive correlations between identification with Taiwanese democracy and exclusively Taiwanese identification (Qi and Lin, 2021), and between support for democracy and support for Taiwanese independence and sovereignty (Chen, 2024). These correlations suggest democracy should matter for national membership, but they do not show how much, nor whether it can carry weight against the most strongly ascriptive markers. Is it possible, for instance, for a person born in Mainland China or Southeast Asia to be recognized as a member of the national community on the strength of democratic commitment? The question is harder still because “support for democracy” is not univocal. Shi and Lu (2010) show that East Asian publics often endorse democracy in name while understanding it through a *minben* (people-as-the-root) framework that judges legitimacy more by government responsiveness than by procedural features. We return to that distinction in the design (Section 4) and use a procedural lib-dem subgroup as a robustness check.

Contestation

The third claim is that identity is the central axis of political contestation in Taiwan. After democratization, identity and the cross-strait relationship became the primary cleavage of voter polarization (Hsiao, 2014; Huang and Kuo, 2022; Huang, 2019; Qi, 2016). A large literature explains the rise of exclusive Taiwanese identification through electoral mobilization by the DPP (Chen, 2014; Wang et al., 2025), school

curriculum reform (Chen, Lin and Yang, 2023; Schubert, 2004), the threat from the People’s Republic (Wang and Huang, 2023; Wang, 2017; Lin, Qi and Zhang, 2026), and generational replacement. This work has done much to explain the rise of the identity *label* but says less about the substantive *content* the label carries.

The categorical identity question fielded by the NCCU Election Study Center is the standard measurement tool. It asks respondents whether they identify as Taiwanese, Chinese, or both. Exclusive Taiwanese identification has risen from a small minority in the early 1990s to roughly 62% in 2023, while exclusive Chinese identification has fallen to single digits and the “both” category sits at about 32% (Election Study Center, National Chengchi University, 2024). Observers have long noted that, despite severe polarization over identity *labels*, there is also a sphere of identity *consensus* on what Shen and Wu (2008, p. 137) call “political citizenship,” a shared baseline about who counts and on what grounds (see also Schubert, 2004; Zhong, 2016). The open question is whether the substantive content respondents endorse is more consensual than the label distributions suggest.

The conjoint design addresses each of these open questions empirically. It estimates how much weight respondents place on ascriptive markers relative to civic and voluntarist ones, tests whether voluntarist and civic markers can carry weight against ascriptive penalties, and shows whether the content respondents endorse converges across categorical-identity subgroups even when the labels themselves divide them.

4 Research Design

Sample and Data Collection

We fielded an original online survey of 2,050 respondents in Taiwan between May and June 2024 through Qualtrics, quota-matched to the adult population on age, gender, and region. The survey included a conventional ISSP-style identity battery, a binary conjoint experiment (CBC #1), and a multi-level conjoint experiment (CBC #2). Each respondent evaluated six forced-choice tasks per conjoint, for twelve conjoint tasks in total. Respondents were prompted to choose, between two hypothetical persons, the one

they considered to be a national of their country.¹ Attribute order and levels were fully randomized, satisfying the assumptions required for nonparametric identification of AMCEs (Hainmueller, Hopkins and Yamamoto, 2014).

Observational Battery

The battery is based on the ISSP National Identity module. The full survey instrument included ten items asking respondents to rate the importance of each criterion for being a “true national” on a four-point scale. We exclude one item (“follows Taiwan’s cultural norms”) from the analysis because it cross-loads heavily on multiple factors, leaving nine items used here. The nine criteria were Han ancestry, being born in Taiwan, ROC citizenship, speaking Mandarin, speaking Taiwanese, feeling Taiwanese, respecting the political system, knowing history and traditions, and having lived in Taiwan. Following Shulman (2002) and our factor analysis (Appendix ?? of the SI), we classify these items as ascriptive (Han ancestry, Mandarin, Taiwanese, traditions), civic (born in Taiwan, citizenship, residence), and voluntarist (feels Taiwanese, respects the political system). Two items load across factors and are flagged accordingly in the figure.

CBC #1: Binary Design

The first conjoint experiment replicates the ISSP battery content in a conjoint format. Each task presents two hypothetical persons who vary across eight binary attributes, covering feeling (“feels Taiwanese” vs. “doesn’t feel Taiwanese”), ancestry (“ethnic Han” vs. “non-ethnic Han”), citizenship (“ROC citizen” vs. “not an ROC citizen”), language (“speaks Mandarin” vs. “doesn’t speak Mandarin”), origin (“born in Taiwan” vs. “not born in Taiwan”), residence (“lived most of life in Taiwan” vs. “lived most of life outside Taiwan”), political system (“respects Taiwan’s political system” vs. “shows little regard for system”), and

¹The literal Chinese stem translates as “becoming a true national of our country” for the observational battery and “please select which person is more like a national of our country” for the conjoint task. We chose this country-neutral wording deliberately. Using “Taiwanese” in the question stem would have conflated the criterion with the self-identification that it is meant to measure, since “Taiwanese” is itself a response option in the categorical-identity question used by survey instruments such as the NCCU Election Study Center battery. Respondents understood “our country” as Taiwan and the ROC given the survey context. We use “a true national” or “a national of our country” throughout the paper. The full original Chinese question wording is reproduced in the SI.

tradition (“understands Taiwan’s history” vs. “doesn’t know much about history”). All attributes are fully randomized. The survey item asks respondents to choose, between the two profiles, the person they consider to be a national of their country.

This design enables direct comparison with the observational battery. While the battery and the binary conjoint cover overlapping content, they are not identical. The battery includes nine items while CBC #1 uses eight binary attributes, and the response formats differ fundamentally. The battery elicits independent importance ratings. The conjoint forces trade-offs.

CBC #2: Multi-Level Design

The second conjoint experiment uses a more elaborate design with nine attributes, each having two to four levels. Table I summarizes the attributes, their levels, and the rationale for each attribute’s inclusion.

Attribute	Levels	Rationale
Ancestry	Han Chinese Non-Han person (ref.)	Captures the basic ethnic distinction in a majority-Han society where “common blood” has historically been central to Chinese national identity claims.
Origin	Taiwan (ref.) Mainland China Indonesia USA South Korea	Five birthplace categories with politically distinct valences for Taiwan: Mainland Chinese origin, Indonesia as the largest Southeast Asian source country for marriage migration and labor, the US as the most central strategic benefactor, and South Korea as a regional democratic comparator.
Language	Fluent Mandarin Limited proficiency Cannot speak Mandarin (ref.)	Tests whether Mandarin proficiency, the legacy of decades of KMT-imposed language policy, functions as a criterion for national membership.
Legal Status	Taiwanese citizen Permanent resident Short-term resident (ref.)	Measures the weight of formal legal membership and depth of legal ties relative to other identity criteria.
Residence	Lived most/entire life in Taiwan 21 years 14 years 7 years or less (ref.)	Assesses whether duration of residence serves as a proxy for commitment to and integration into the national community.
Sentiment	Identifies as Taiwanese Identifies as both Taiwanese and Chinese Identifies as Chinese Does not identify as Taiwanese or Chinese (ref.)	Tests subjective national identification, including the politically central dual-identity category that characterizes roughly 30% of the population.
Politics	Thinks democracy is good despite flaws Strongly opposes communism Thinks democracy is chaotic, prefers one-party rule Has no opinion about politics (ref.)	Four political orientations that separate procedural democratic commitment, anti-communist sentiment, anti-democratic preference for single-party rule, and political apathy.
Culture	Thinks one should respect Taiwan’s values and traditions Thinks diversity should be embraced Thinks cultural practices and beliefs are personal (ref.)	Distinguishes three orientations toward cultural belonging: traditionalist, pluralist, and culturally non-prescriptive.
Civicness	Participates in local politics Helps with community clean-up Stays home or meets friends for coffee (ref.)	Three levels of public engagement: political participation in local campaigns, community-oriented voluntarism, and private socializing.

Table 1: CBC #2 attributes, levels, and design rationale.

Note: Reference levels are marked “(ref).”

The CBC #2 attribute set covers Taiwan-specific content absent from the ISSP battery. The origin attribute distinguishes five birthplace categories with distinct political valences (Taiwan, Mainland China, Indonesia, USA, South Korea). The sentiment attribute includes the “both Taiwanese and Chinese” dual-identity category that is central to Taiwan’s identity politics. The politics attribute separates four orientations toward governance, namely procedural democratic support, anti-communist sentiment, anti-democratic preference for single-party rule, and political apathy. The culture attribute distinguishes traditionalist, pluralist, and non-prescriptive orientations. The civicness attribute distinguishes political participation, community-oriented voluntarism, and private socializing.

Estimation Strategy

We estimate average marginal component effects (AMCEs) and marginal means following Hainmueller, Hopkins and Yamamoto (2014). AMCEs estimate the causal effect of each attribute level on the probability that a profile is selected, relative to the reference category, averaged over the joint distribution of all other attributes. As Bansak et al. (2023) clarify in response to concerns raised by Abramson, Kocak and Magazinnik (2022), AMCEs estimate average causal effects on choice probabilities, not the preferences of a majority. They remain the appropriate quantity for evaluating which attributes causally affect choices in conjoint designs. Marginal means estimate the unconditional probability that a profile with a given attribute level is selected, averaged over all other attributes (Leeper, Hobolt and Tilley, 2020). We report both AMCEs and marginal means throughout, as the latter provide a reference-category-free complement that is particularly useful for subgroup comparisons. We report dual confidence intervals (thick bars for 90% and thin bars for 95%) to allow readers to assess statistical significance at both conventional thresholds.

Conjoint estimates may be attenuated by measurement error arising from inattentive or inconsistent responding. We estimate intra-respondent reliability (IRR) from our data using the extrapolation method proposed by Clayton et al. (2023). We compare choices across task pairs within each respondent, compute agreement rates as a function of the number of attributes that differ between paired tasks, and extrapolate to zero differences via weighted least squares. The resulting IRR estimate allows us to com-

pute bias-corrected AMCEs and marginal means, which we report alongside uncorrected estimates in Appendix ??.

For subgroup analysis, we estimate conditional marginal means and differences in marginal means by two moderating variables, following the approach developed by Leeper, Hobolt and Tilley (2020). Differences in marginal means avoid the reference-category dependence that makes conditional AMCEs potentially misleading. Conditional marginal means estimate the probability that a profile with a given attribute level is chosen, separately for each subgroup. Differences in marginal means test whether a given attribute level has a statistically distinguishable effect across subgroups. Because attribute levels are randomized, subgroup comparisons are identified even when subgroups differ on observables.

Our two moderating variables are Taiwanese identity strength and liberal-democratic values. For Taiwanese identity strength, respondents reported their subjective Taiwanese identity on a 0–10 slider. We dichotomize this variable at the 75th percentile, which in our sample corresponds to a score of 10 (the maximum). Respondents scoring at the 75th percentile or above are classified as “Strong Taiwanese ID” and those below as “Weak Taiwanese ID.” Approximately 56% of the sample falls in the strong category, reflecting the predominance of strong Taiwanese identification in the contemporary population. The full distribution is reported in Appendix ??.

For liberal-democratic values, we construct an 11-item index from a battery of questions about democratic governance. The items target liberal-democratic regime-type aspects (freedom of expression, judicial independence, checks on government power, secular governance) and related civil-rights commitments (gender equality). We exclude substantive welfare or performance-based items that would map onto the people-as-the-root (*minben*) understanding of democracy common in East Asia (Shi and Lu, 2010). One item is inverse-coded, and the total is reflected so that higher scores indicate stronger liberal-democratic values. We dichotomize respondents at the 75th percentile. Those scoring at or above the 75th percentile are classified as “High lib-dem values” and those below as “Low lib-dem values.” This subgroup also serves as a robustness check on the interpretation of the conjoint’s “supports democracy” attribute level. Respondents in the high-lib-dem group are those whose endorsement of democracy is most clearly procedural and rights-based. Using the same percentile threshold for both moderators en-

sure consistency in the subgroup construction and avoids discarding observations from the middle of either distribution.

5 Results

Observational Battery and CBC #1: From Ratings to Trade-offs

We begin by comparing the observational battery with the binary conjoint (CBC #1), which cover overlapping identity criteria in different measurement formats. This comparison shows both the consistency and the added value of the conjoint approach.

Figure 1 presents the results of the conventional national identity battery. For each of the nine retained items, we report the percentage of respondents rating the criterion as “very” or “quite” important for being a true national. Items are colored by their factor-analytic classification (ascriptive, civic, or voluntarist, with details in Appendix ??).

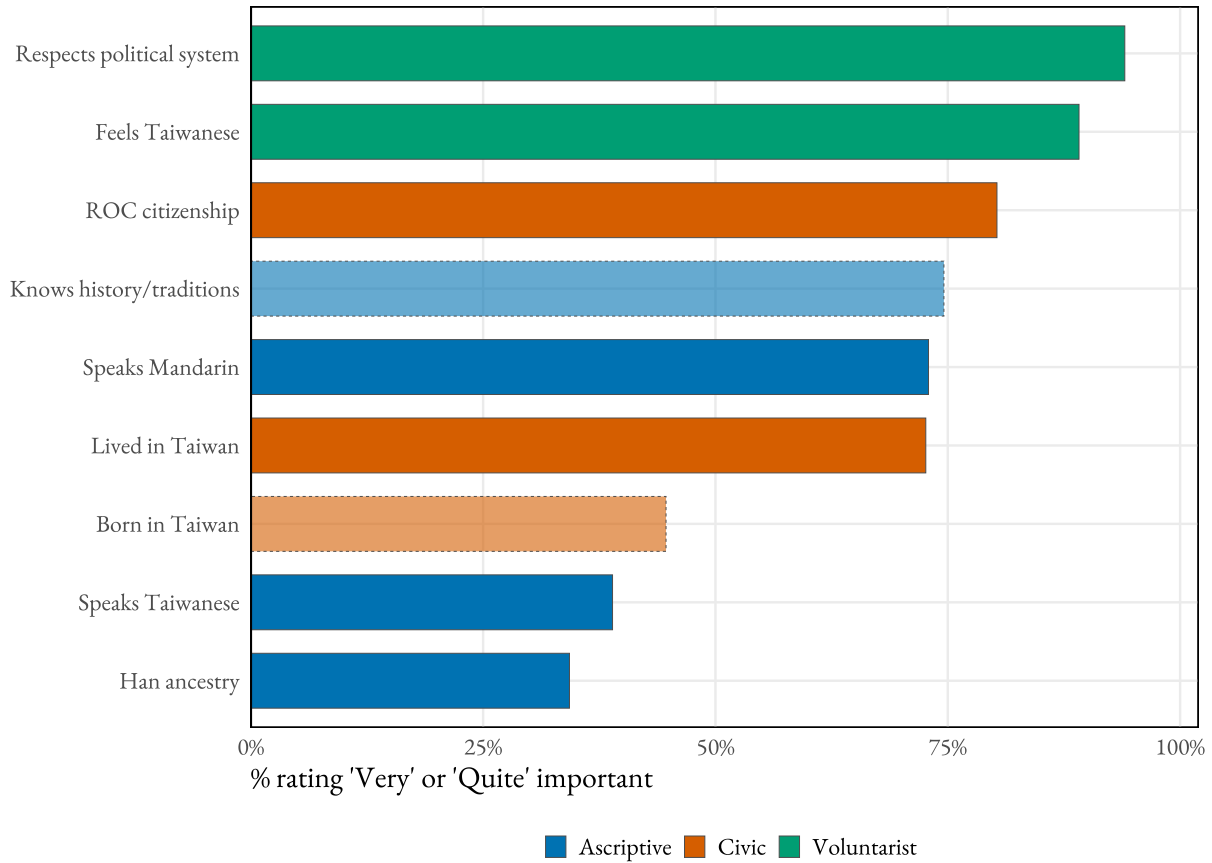


Figure 1: Observational national identity battery, percent rating each criterion as “very” or “quite” important for being a true national.

Note: Items are colored by dimension: ascriptive (blue), civic (orange), and voluntarist (green), following the tripartite classification in Shulman (2002) and Wright, Citrin and Wand (2012), validated by our factor analysis (Appendix ??). Cross-loading items are shown with lighter shading and dashed borders: “born in Taiwan” cross-loads on both the civic and ascriptive factors, and “knows history/traditions” cross-loads on the ascriptive and voluntarist factors. $n = 2,050$.

The battery results illustrate both the strengths and the limits of conventional measurement. The battery correctly identifies the broad hierarchy of identity criteria. Voluntarist and civic items such as “feels Taiwanese,” “respects political system,” and “lived in Taiwan” receive the highest importance ratings (with “respects political system” rated very or quite important by 94% of respondents at the top), while ascriptive items such as “Han ancestry” (34%) and “speaks Taiwanese” receive somewhat lower ratings. This ranking is informative. It suggests that Taiwanese respondents view civic and voluntarist criteria as more important than ascriptive ones even when evaluating each criterion independently. These

are genuine signals. However, the overall distribution is compressed. The difference between the highest-rated and lowest-rated items is modest, and the battery provides no information about which criteria respondents would prioritize when they conflict. The battery shows, for example, that “respects political system” is rated highly. It cannot show what “respecting the political system” actually means to respondents. The phrase could mean supporting democracy, accepting government authority, or simply having a political opinion. The multi-level conjoint (CBC #2) will address this limitation directly.

Figure 2 presents the AMCEs from CBC #1, the binary conjoint that covers the same identity criteria. The conjoint confirms the battery’s broad ranking while adding important information. Feeling Taiwanese produces the largest AMCE (+20pp), followed by lifelong residence, ROC citizenship, and respecting the political system, consistent with the battery’s finding that voluntarist and civic criteria are rated most important. Han ancestry shows the smallest non-zero effect (+4pp), again consistent with the battery.

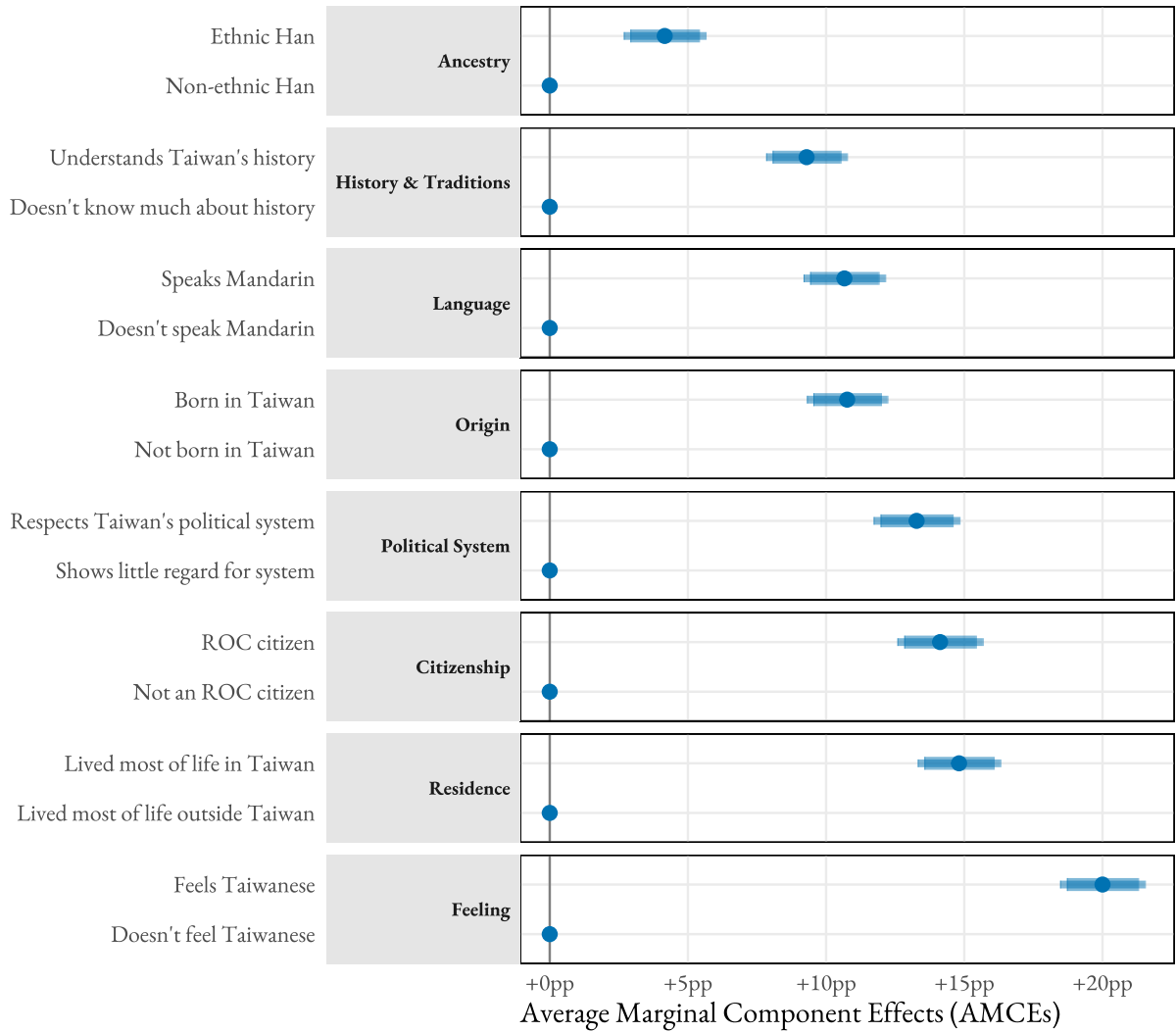


Figure 2: CBC #1: Average marginal component effects for eight binary identity attributes.

Note: Points show estimated AMCEs with dual confidence intervals (thick: 90%; thin: 95%). Attributes ordered by effect magnitude. Reference categories are the “absence” or “weaker” framing for each attribute. $n = 2,050$ respondents, six tasks each.

The consistency between the two approaches is itself a useful finding, as it suggests that the conjoint design clarifies the same broad result. Where the battery shows that most attributes matter, the conjoint quantifies *how much* each matters relative to the others. This is the kind of information theories of national identity require. The conjoint also shows the magnitude of trade-offs. For instance, the AMCE for respecting Taiwan’s political system is substantially larger than the AMCE for ethnic Han ancestry, suggesting that respondents who are forced to choose between a person of non-Han ancestry who respects

the political system and a person of Han ancestry who does not would favor the former. This kind of trade-off information is unavailable from any item-by-item, observational battery.

At the same time, the battery does distinguish more important from less important criteria. The conjoint's value is to resolve an ambiguity that rating scales cannot resolve by design. What the battery and CBC #1 together cannot do, however, is unpack the substantive content of broad criteria like "political system" or "national sentiment." This is precisely where the multi-level design of CBC #2 becomes essential.

CBC #2: The Multi-Level Identity Space

The multi-level conjoint (CBC #2) provides a more detailed mapping of Taiwan's national identity space by replacing binary contrasts with the variation that characterizes real-world identity debates. It unpacks the broad criteria that the battery and CBC #1 measured as single items. Where the battery asks whether "respecting the political system" matters for national belonging, CBC #2 distinguishes four political orientations. These are support for democracy despite its flaws, strong opposition to communism, a preference for single-party authoritarian rule, and political apathy. Where the battery asks whether "feeling Taiwanese" matters, CBC #2 separates four types of national sentiment. These are exclusive Taiwanese, dual Taiwanese-Chinese, exclusive Chinese, and no national identification. This multi-level structure allows us to identify which specific configuration of each criterion drives perceptions of national belonging. Figure 3 presents AMCEs and marginal means for all nine attributes. AMCEs report the effect of each level relative to its reference category. Marginal means report the absolute probability that a profile with a given attribute is chosen.

Several findings emerge from the second design. Among the sentiment attribute levels, identifying as Taiwanese produces the largest positive AMCE (+17pp), while identifying as Chinese produces a negative effect (−5pp). Identifying as "both Taiwanese and Chinese," the dual identity held by roughly 30% of the population, occupies an intermediate position (+10pp) but still yields a positive AMCE relative to the reference category (no national identification). This confirms that national sentiment is the single most consequential identity criterion, and that the content of that sentiment matters. Taiwanese identi-

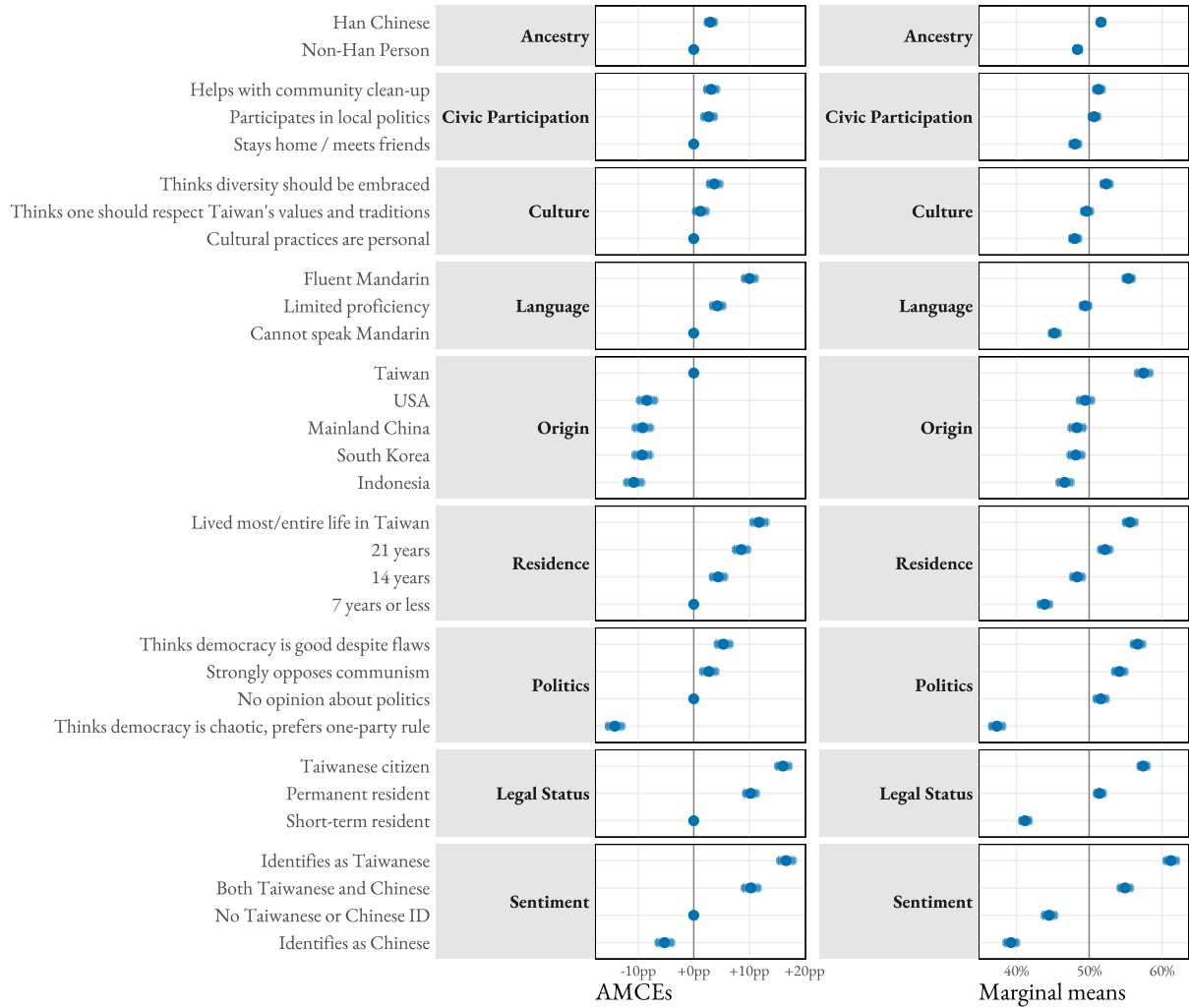


Figure 3: CBC #2: Average marginal component effects (left) and marginal means (right) for all nine identity attributes.

Note: Points show estimates with dual confidence intervals (thick: 90%; thin: 95%). Attributes and levels ordered by effect magnitude. $n = 2,050$ respondents, six tasks each.

fication is rewarded, Chinese identification is penalized, and dual identification falls in between.

Among the political attributes, the estimates for the four levels align with theory. Profiles described as “thinks democracy is good despite flaws” (+5pp) or “strongly opposes communism” (+3pp) produce small-to-moderate positive AMCEs relative to the apathy reference category. Profiles described as “thinks democracy is chaotic, prefers one-party rule” produce a large negative AMCE (−14pp), the largest among the political contrasts and the most disqualifying single attribute level in the design. Political apathy (the reference) sits near the midpoint, indicating that having no political opinion is neutral for perceived national membership while active anti-democratic preferences are penalized. The procedural-democratic and anti-communist levels both contribute positively and capture distinct political meanings. The procedural-democratic level captures regime-type endorsement (democracy as flawed but legitimate), while the anti-communist level captures sentiment toward the People’s Republic. Their separation matters for the subgroup analysis below, where a strong reaction to the anti-democratic-preference level among high-lib-dem respondents would isolate procedural commitment from anti-PRC sentiment.

Civic participation (volunteering in community and attending civic meetings), cultural engagement (participating in local Taiwanese religious activities), and language (speaking both Mandarin and Taiwanese) all produce positive effects, though smaller in magnitude than sentiment and political orientation. These secondary attributes are nevertheless informative. Civic engagement and cultural participation both matter for perceived national membership, suggesting that Taiwanese national identity rewards active participation in community life alongside demographic characteristics.

The ancestry and origin estimates complicate simple ethnic or nativist narratives. Han ancestry produces only a small positive AMCE (+3pp), and the four non-Taiwan origin levels produce penalties between −9pp and −11pp relative to the Taiwan reference. These ascriptive effects are modest compared to the civic and voluntarist contrasts. A person of non-Han ancestry who feels Taiwanese and supports democracy is judged a more representative member of the national community than a person of Han ancestry who lacks these civic and voluntarist attributes. This is a significant finding for a society that is ethnically majority Han. Ethnic criteria exist as identity markers but are clearly secondary to political and voluntarist criteria in determining perceived national belonging.

Subgroup Analysis: Consensus on Civic and Voluntarist Content

The preceding results establish the overall structure of Taiwan’s national identity space. We now turn to subgroup analysis to test the consensus hypothesis introduced in Section 3 that the substantive *content* respondents endorse is more consensual than the contested categorical *labels* would suggest. Conventional batteries can show whether different groups rate different criteria as important. They cannot show whether groups trade off criteria differently. The conjoint format can. By estimating conditional marginal means for each subgroup separately, we observe which criteria each group values and how those criteria are weighed against competing alternatives. Differences in marginal means between subgroups then test whether trade-off patterns diverge significantly.

Identity Category (Taiwanese only vs. Both)

The standard cleavage in the Taiwan-identity literature is the categorical-identity question used by the NCCU Election Study Center. Respondents pick exclusive Taiwanese, exclusive Chinese, or both. Figure 4 presents conditional marginal means (left) and differences in marginal means (right) by this cleavage, comparing the two largest groups, exclusive Taiwanese identifiers ($n = 1,265$) and dual identifiers ($n = 664$). Exclusive Chinese identifiers and respondents declining a category are excluded due to small cell sizes.

The pattern supports the consensus hypothesis. On most attributes, the two groups produce statistically indistinguishable marginal means. Ancestry, language, citizenship, residence duration, civicness, and culture all show small and largely insignificant differences between Taiwanese-only and Both respondents. The criteria that have featured most prominently in qualitative debates about Taiwanese national identity, including ascriptive markers like Han ancestry and Mandarin proficiency, are weighted similarly by the two groups.

Where the groups diverge is exactly where theory predicts they should, on the politically charged sentiment, politics, and origin attributes. Taiwanese-only respondents place considerably greater weight on “identifies as Taiwanese” (diff-in-MM = +9.1pp) and considerably less weight on “identifies as Chinese” (−9.4pp) compared to dual identifiers. They are also more responsive to the political attribute,

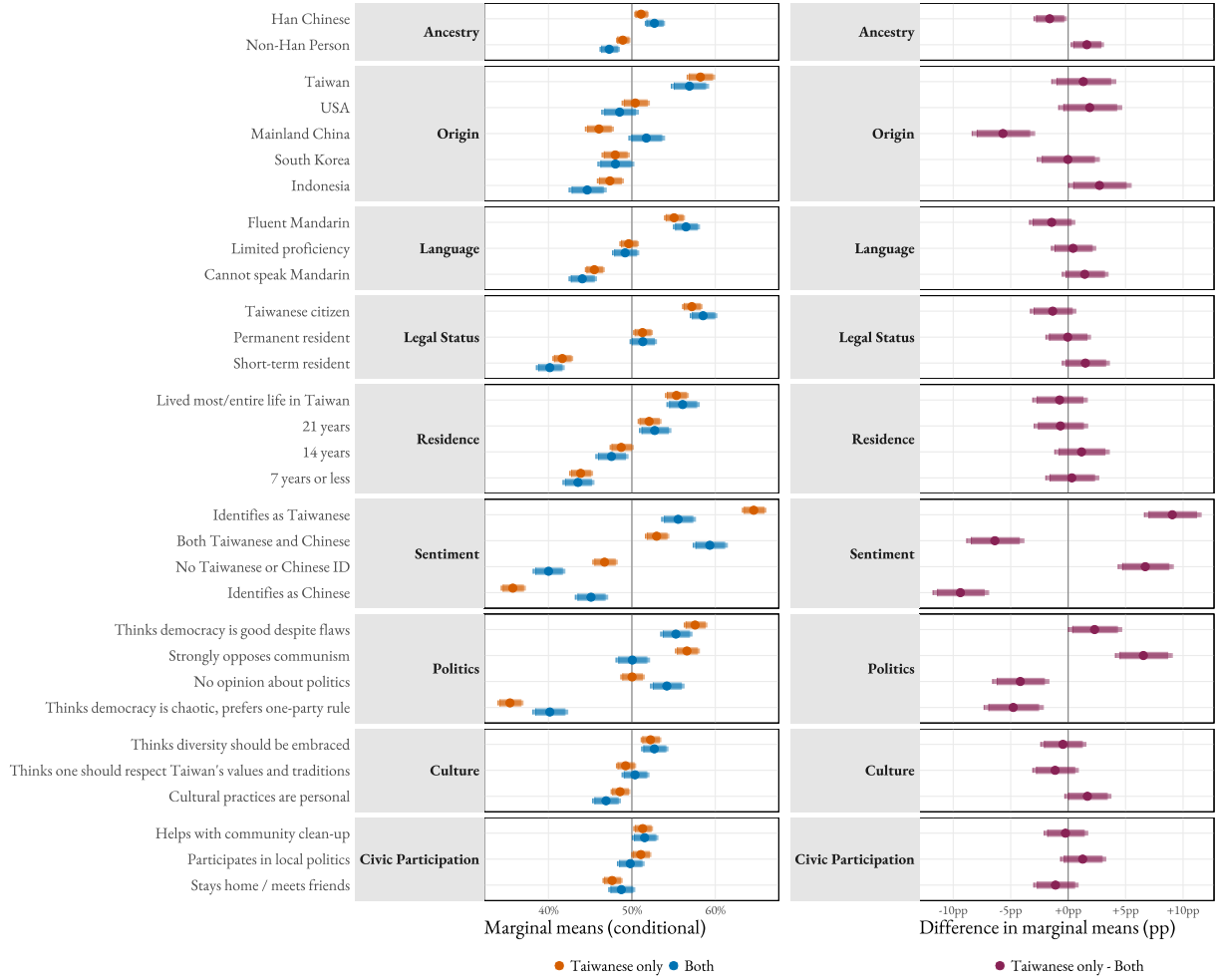


Figure 4: Subgroup analysis by categorical identity (Taiwanese only vs. both Taiwanese and Chinese).

Note: Left panel shows conditional marginal means; right panel shows differences in marginal means (Taiwanese only minus Both). Dual confidence intervals shown (thick: 90%; thin: 95%). Exclusive Chinese identifiers and respondents declining a category are excluded due to small cell sizes ($n_{\text{Taiwanese only}} = 1,265$; $n_{\text{Both}} = 664$).

with opposition to communism (+6.6pp) and rejection of single-party rule (−4.8pp) drawing stronger reactions in this group. Mainland China origin produces a larger penalty for Taiwanese-only respondents (−5.7pp). All of these differences survive Benjamini-Hochberg correction (Appendix ??).

The conjoint design identifies what the categorical-identity question alone cannot. Taiwanese-only and Both respondents share a wide consensus on what national membership requires across most criteria, and they disagree along the specific axes that the categorical-identity question itself encodes (sentiment, China-relations, regime preference). The disagreement is real and narrowly bounded, and the consensus runs across the rest of the criteria.

Voluntarist Override of Ascriptive Penalties

A natural next question is whether voluntarist and civic attributes are powerful enough to overcome ascriptive penalties when the two conflict. We test this on the two most ascriptive criteria in CBC #2, ancestry and birthplace, with parallel step-up specifications. The left panel of Figure 5 holds Non-Han ancestry fixed and adds, in turn, a voluntarist marker (identifies as Taiwanese), a civic marker (supports democracy), and both together. The right panel does the same for foreign-born profiles, defined as origin in any country other than Taiwan. Standard errors are robust and clustered on respondent. Dual 90% and 95% confidence intervals are shown on the figure.

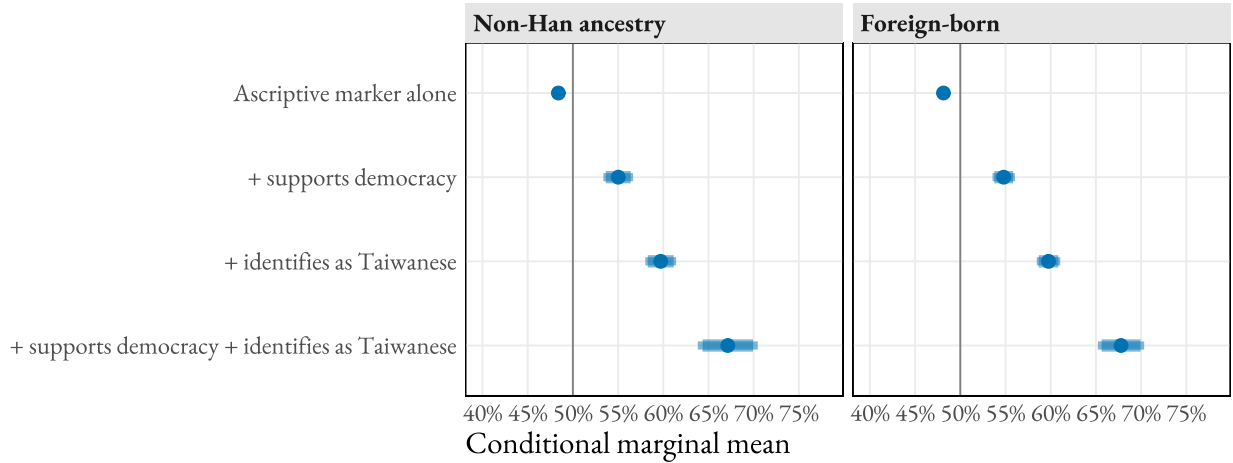


Figure 5: Conditional marginal means for stacked voluntarist and civic markers on the two most ascriptive criteria.

Note: Each row reports the conditional marginal mean of selecting a profile whose attributes are held at the values shown, with remaining attributes fully randomized. Robust standard errors clustered on respondent. Dual confidence intervals shown (thick: 90%; thin: 95%). Ascriptive-only rows have visibly tight intervals because n_{tasks} runs in the thousands. The triple-condition cells have the widest intervals because the joint subset is smallest.

Holding Non-Han ancestry fixed produces a small ascriptive penalty (MM $\sim 48\%$). Adding either marker individually exceeds parity (see figure for intermediate cells), and bundling both produces a conditional marginal mean of 67%, 17 percentage points above parity and slightly above the 66% additive prediction implied by the two single-condition cells. The right panel shows the same pattern for foreign-born profiles. The ascriptive-only mean is again about 48%, and bundling both markers produces a mean of 68%, slightly above the 67% additive prediction. Voluntarist and civic markers are nearly additive in either specification, with a small positive interaction. Any one of these markers more than offsets the ascriptive penalty, and bundling them produces a profile that respondents prefer over the average alternative by a wide margin.

The same logic extends to the most restrictive “low ascriptive” cell, in which Non-Han ancestry and Mainland China origin are pinned simultaneously. Appendix ?? of the SI reports conditional marginal means for the remaining seven attributes in that cell, and Appendix ?? compares the both-pinned cell against pinning each ascriptive marker alone. Almost every voluntarist and civic level, including identifying as Taiwanese, supporting democracy, lifelong residence, ROC citizenship, fluent Mandarin, and

anti-communist political orientation, produces a conditional marginal mean above parity in the both-pinned cell, with marginal means somewhat lower than in the single-pinned cells because the ascriptive penalty is heavier. Respondents agree that the substance of national membership is voluntarist and civic, and profiles that signal that commitment are evaluated as members of the community even when ancestry and origin are at their lowest values.

Robustness across additional subgroups

We report subgroup analysis by Taiwanese identity strength (Appendix ?? of the SI), liberal-democratic values (Appendix ??), waishengren versus benshengren ancestry, education, gender, and partisanship (Appendix ??). The lib-dem split addresses the *minben* caveat introduced in Section 3. Respondents in the high lib-dem group are those whose endorsement of democratic governance is unambiguously procedural and rights-based, and the conjoint’s political attribute separates them from low-lib-dem respondents in the expected direction: high-lib-dem respondents are markedly more averse to anti-democratic-preference profiles. Because subgroup analysis involves multiple simultaneous comparisons, we apply Benjamini-Hochberg FDR correction jointly across diff-in-MM estimates from the Taiwanese identity strength and lib-dem subgroup comparisons (Appendix ??). The same patterns recur across multiple independently motivated subgroup comparisons, strengthening confidence in the main findings.

6 Discussion and Conclusion

Our results indicate that conjoint experiments offer meaningful measurement advantages over conventional national identity batteries. The observational battery produces compressed distributions in which most criteria receive high importance ratings. The conjoint format forces respondents to make trade-offs and yields a differentiated ranking of identity criteria, which lets us identify the attributes that actually drive perceptions of national belonging. The battery (Figure 1) and CBC #1 (Figure 2) both place voluntarist and civic criteria above ascriptive ones. The conjoint then quantifies the relative weight of each criterion and gives us the trade-off structure that compressed ratings obscure. CBC #2 goes further, decomposing broad criteria like “political system” and “national sentiment” into specific configurations

whose meanings for perceived membership we can identify. Democratic political orientation is comparable to national sentiment as a predictor, and the four political levels separate procedural democratic commitment, anti-PRC sentiment, and anti-democratic preference, a separation that no item-by-item battery can perform.

The substantive findings confirm that Taiwan's national identity is primarily civic and voluntarist, with ascriptive criteria playing secondary roles. Feeling Taiwanese, supporting democracy, and engaging in civic life are the strongest predictors of perceived national belonging. Ancestry and language matter but play secondary roles. Subgroup analysis by categorical identity (Taiwanese only vs. Both Taiwanese and Chinese) shows that the substantive content respondents endorse is more consensual than the contested labels would suggest. The two groups produce statistically indistinguishable marginal means on most attributes (ancestry, language, citizenship, residence, civicness, culture) and diverge only on the politically charged sentiment, politics, and origin attributes, exactly where divergence is theoretically expected. Even here, most differences are matters of different emphasis rather than principle. The interaction analysis extends this picture. Even when ancestry and origin are held at their "low" settings (non-Han, born in Mainland China), voluntarist and civic levels (identifying as Taiwanese, supporting procedural democracy, lifelong residence, ROC citizenship, fluent Mandarin, anti-communist orientation) all produce conditional marginal means above 50 percent, with confidence intervals that exclude the parity line. Voluntarist commitment is sufficient for parity even where ascriptive markers are weak.

The findings also provide new insights into debates about whether nationalism is inherently illiberal or whether it can be tightly linked to democratic values (Tamir, 1993; Banting et al., 2020; Greenfeld, 1992; Hur, 2022). In the Taiwanese case, the conjoint suggests that democratic commitment is internalized as one criterion for national membership among others, particularly among strong national identifiers and respondents with procedural liberal-democratic values. Stronger characterizations of Taiwanese nationalism as liberal-democratic in its dominant form could be sharpened with latent-class analysis of the conjoint responses, an extension we leave for future work. What our results support is the more measured conclusion that liberal-democratic markers are widely shared and weight heavily in respondents' evaluations of national membership. The procedural lib-dem robustness check (Appendix ??) confirms

that this democratic content has procedural weight in our data. Nodia (1992) argued that democracy and nationalism are “two sides of the same coin,” and our data suggest that across the majority of Taiwanese respondents—and most clearly among those who identify exclusively as Taiwanese—democratic commitment functions as a criterion for who counts as a national of the country. Profiles described as thinking democracy is good despite its flaws are chosen as “more truly national” about 57% of the time across the sample, while profiles preferring one-party rule are chosen only 37% of the time, with the same gap appearing among Taiwanese-only identifiers. Democratic commitment functions as a component of national distinctiveness from authoritarian China (Ho, 2022; Wachman, 1994; Rigger, 2011).

This bears on a longstanding theoretical debate. Linz and Stepan (1996) argued that democratic consolidation presupposes prior agreement on the boundaries of the political community, and vom Hau et al. (2023) note that the downstream effects of nationalism depend more on the specific content of the identity than on its mere intensity. Our results address that content distinction. Where the content respondents endorse is civic and democratic, the nationalism a polity sustains can support liberal institutions.

The conjoint approach is portable. Any setting in which researchers want to know how citizens weigh competing criteria for national membership can benefit from the forced-choice format, and comparative designs could field identical conjoint batteries across countries (Göbel, Traunmüller and Schmidt-Catran, 2023; Bøggild et al., 2024). The format is particularly valuable in contexts where national identity is contested or undergoing transformation, such as transitional democracies, post-conflict societies, and immigration-receiving countries (Hainmueller and Hopkins, 2015). In countries where democratic backsliding is a concern, conjoint experiments could show whether democratic institutions have become embedded in national identity sufficiently to function as a bulwark against authoritarian reversion, or whether they remain peripheral to how citizens define their national community. The ISSP has fielded its National Identity module four times since 1995 (ISSP Research Group, 1998, 2012, 2015, 2026). Adding a conjoint component to future waves could dramatically increase the information yield of each survey.

Several limitations qualify our conclusions. The online quota-matched sample may not perfectly represent the Taiwanese adult population. The conjoint format asks respondents to evaluate hypothetical

persons, so their choices may diverge from how they apply identity criteria in real-world encounters. The format mitigates social desirability bias (Horiuchi, Markovich and Yamamoto, 2022) without eliminating it. Like all conjoint experiments, our estimates are subject to measurement error from inattentive responding. Lastly, the study is cross-sectional. Panel designs could track how identity structures evolve, a particularly promising application in Taiwan given the rapid identity change documented in NCCU data (Election Study Center, National Chengchi University, 2024), but such an effort is beyond the scope of this particular study.

At a time when questions of national belonging are politically salient across the world, the ability to estimate how respondents weigh identity criteria against one another, in addition to whether they value each criterion in isolation, represents a meaningful advance in our toolkit for understanding nationalism. Nationalism and pro-democratic sentiment, our results from Taiwan suggest, can be tightly linked, while the substance of national identity can be more consensual than the contest over its labels makes it appear.

Ethics

This research follows standards set out by the University of Vienna Ethics Committee and was reviewed under decision no. 00997. All respondents provided informed consent prior to participation.

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Replication Materials

Replication materials are available upon request from the corresponding author and will be posted to an appropriate dataverse upon publication.

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Supplementary Information

Measuring National Identity with Conjoint Experiments Using the Case of Taiwan

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May 24, 2026

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A Sample Characteristics

Table A.1 reports the characteristics of our sample.

Variable	Category	N	%
Age	18–29	431	21.1
	30–39	534	26.1
	40–49	541	26.4
	50–59	349	17.1
	60+	191	9.3
Gender	Female	962	46.9
	Male	1088	53.1
Education	Graduate school	509	24.8
	Junior high or below	113	5.5
	Senior high / vocational	379	18.5
	University / college	1049	51.2
Region	Capital Area	841	41.0
	Central Taiwan	357	17.4
	Eastern Taiwan	18	0.9
	Northern Taiwan	304	14.8
	Offshore Islands	5	0.2
	Southern Taiwan	525	25.6
Ethnicity (father)	Benshengren	1727	84.2
	Other/Mixed	36	1.8
	Waishengren	287	14.0
Partisanship	DPP	461	22.6
	Don't know	484	23.7
	Green Party	7	0.3
	KMT	489	24.0
	NPP	36	1.8
	New Party	8	0.4
	Other parties	58	2.8
	PFP	12	0.6
	SDP	2	0.1
	TPP	481	23.6
	TSU	1	0.0
Identity	Both	664	33.4
	Chinese only	29	1.5
	Neither	30	1.5
	Taiwanese only	1265	63.6

Table A.1: Sample characteristics ($n = 2,050$).

Note: Quotas applied on age, gender, and region during recruitment via Qualtrics. Education is grouped into four categories; the underlying years-of-education variable is continuous in the data file.

B Factor Analysis of Battery Items

We conduct an exploratory factor analysis of the nine observational battery items to empirically validate the ascriptive, civic, and voluntarist classification used in the main text. We extract three factors using maximum likelihood estimation with oblimin rotation, which permits correlated factors. Table B.1 reports the factor loadings for each item.

The three-factor solution aligns with the theoretical classification. The ascriptive factor loads most heavily on Han ancestry, speaking Mandarin, and speaking Taiwanese. The civic factor loads on ROC citizenship, being born in Taiwan, and residence duration. The voluntarist factor loads on feeling Taiwanese and respecting the political system. Two items exhibit cross-loadings: being born in Taiwan loads on both the civic and ascriptive factors, and knowing history and traditions loads on both the ascriptive and voluntarist factors. These cross-loadings are substantively plausible, as birthplace can be understood as both an ascriptive characteristic and a formal marker of civic membership, while knowledge of history and traditions blends cultural engagement with inherited community membership. We assign each item to its primary factor but indicate cross-loading items with reduced opacity and dashed borders in the battery figure (Figure ?? of the main paper).

Item	Ascriptive	Civic	Voluntarist	Classification	Cross-loading
Han ancestry	0.453	0.102	-0.078	Ascriptive	
Knows history/traditions	0.498	-0.057	0.339	Ascriptive	Yes
Speaks Mandarin	0.417	0.228	0.093	Ascriptive	
Speaks Taiwanese	0.649	0.069	0.001	Ascriptive	
Born in Taiwan	0.336	0.526	-0.149	Civic	Yes
Lived in Taiwan	0.086	0.542	0.110	Civic	
ROC citizenship	-0.067	0.623	0.151	Civic	
Feels Taiwanese	0.041	0.157	0.525	Voluntarist	
Respects political system	0.012	0.021	0.750	Voluntarist	

Table B.1: Factor loadings for national identity battery items, three-factor oblimin rotation.

Note: Maximum-likelihood extraction with oblimin rotation ($n = 2,050$). Oblimin rotation permits correlated factors, which is theoretically appropriate because ascriptive, civic, and voluntarist identity dimensions are expected to co-vary within individuals. Loadings ≥ 0.30 on multiple factors indicate cross-loading items.

C Moderating Variable Distributions

Figure C.1 shows the distribution of Taiwanese identity strength (0–10 slider) in our sample. The distribution is strongly left-skewed, with a mode at 10 and a median at the 50th percentile. We dichotomize respondents at the 75th percentile (a score of 10) for subgroup analysis. Approximately 56% of the sample scores at the maximum, reflecting the predominance of strong Taiwanese identification in the contemporary population. Figure C.2 shows the distribution of the liberal democracy score; we dichotomize respondents at the 75th percentile, classifying those at or above as “High lib-dem values.”

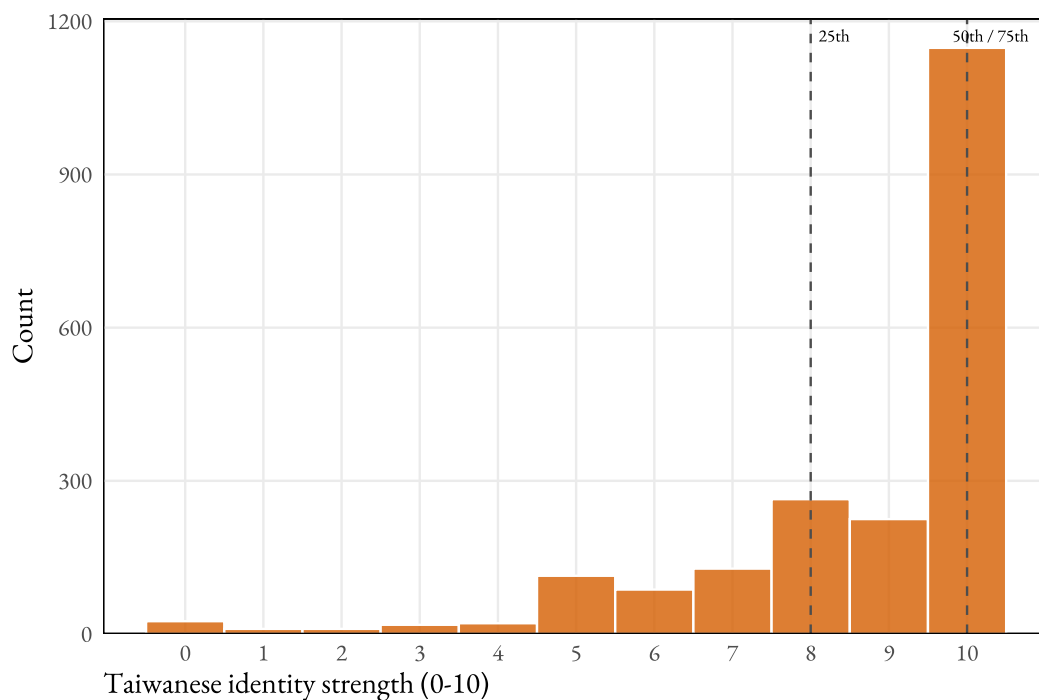


Figure C.1: Distribution of Taiwanese identity strength (0–10 slider).

Note: Dashed lines indicate the 25th, 50th, and 75th percentiles. The distribution is strongly left-skewed: the modal response is 10, and 56% of respondents fall at or above the 75th-percentile cut. $n = 2,050$.

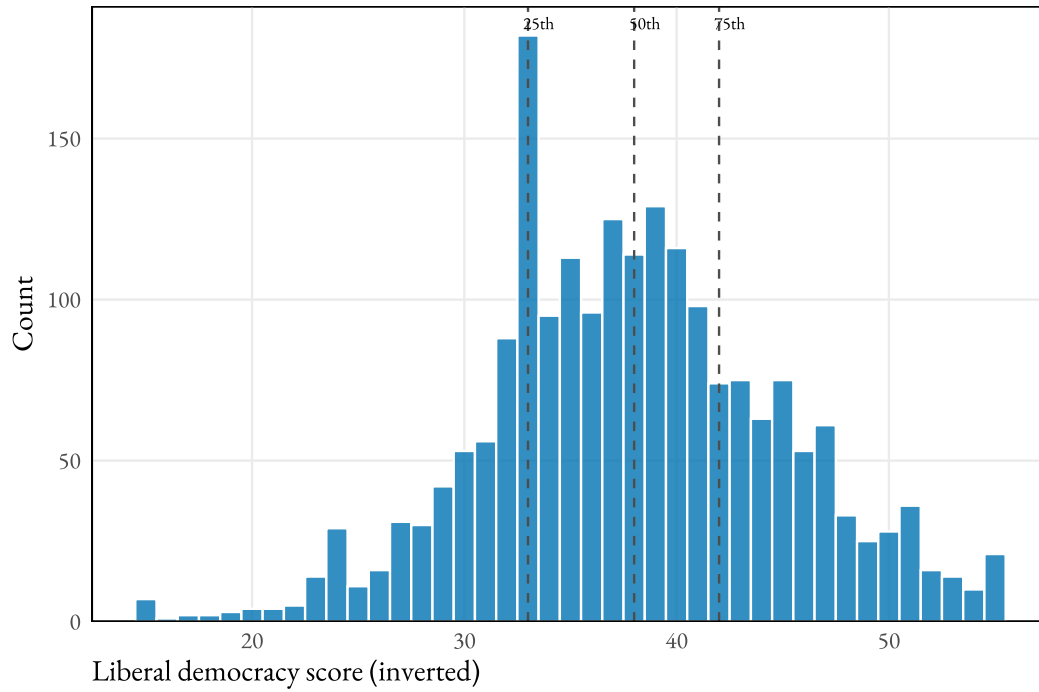


Figure C.2: Distribution of liberal-democratic values (11-item index, inverted).

Note: Dashed lines indicate the 25th, 50th, and 75th percentiles. The distribution is approximately normal. The 75th-percentile cut classifies ~28% of respondents as “High lib-dem.” $n = 2,050$.

D Additional Subgroup Analyses

We conduct additional subgroup analyses to assess the robustness and generality of the main findings. Each analysis follows the same approach as the main text: we estimate conditional marginal means for each subgroup and differences in marginal means to test for statistically significant divergence.

D.1 Waishengren vs. Benshengren

Figure D.1 compares respondents whose fathers are classified as *waishengren* (mainlanders, families who arrived from mainland China after 1945) with those classified as *benshengren* (native Taiwanese). This cleavage is one of the most historically significant in Taiwanese politics, reflecting divergent experiences of colonization, migration, and authoritarian rule.

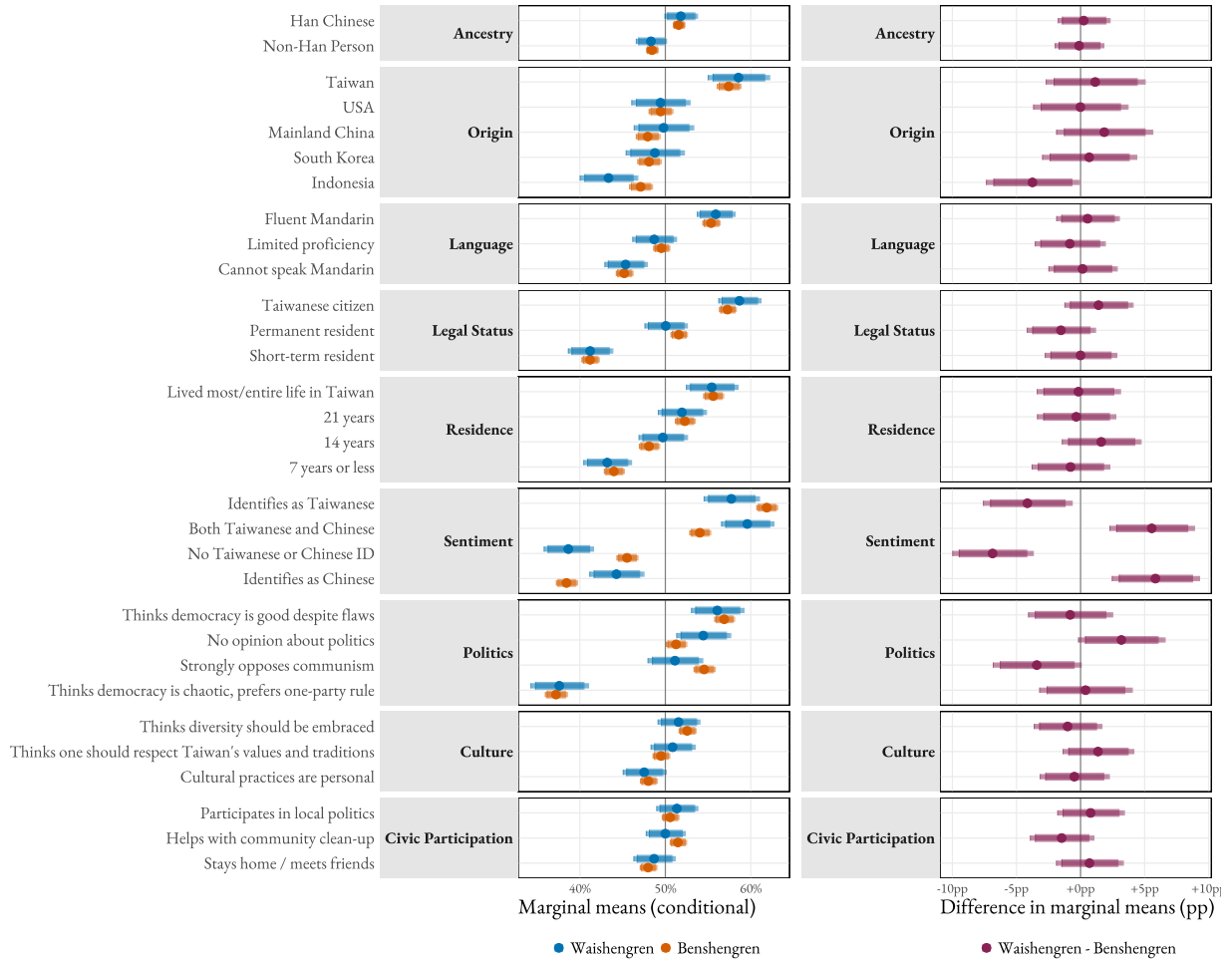


Figure D.1: Subgroup analysis by waishengren/benshengren classification (based on father's origin).
Note: Left: conditional marginal means. Right: differences in marginal means (benshengren minus waishengren). Dual confidence intervals shown (thick: 90%; thin: 95%).

D.2 Education

Figure D.2 compares respondents with university-level education or above with those without. Education may shape both the content and structure of national identity through exposure to cosmopolitan values, critical thinking about political institutions, and differential socialization experiences.

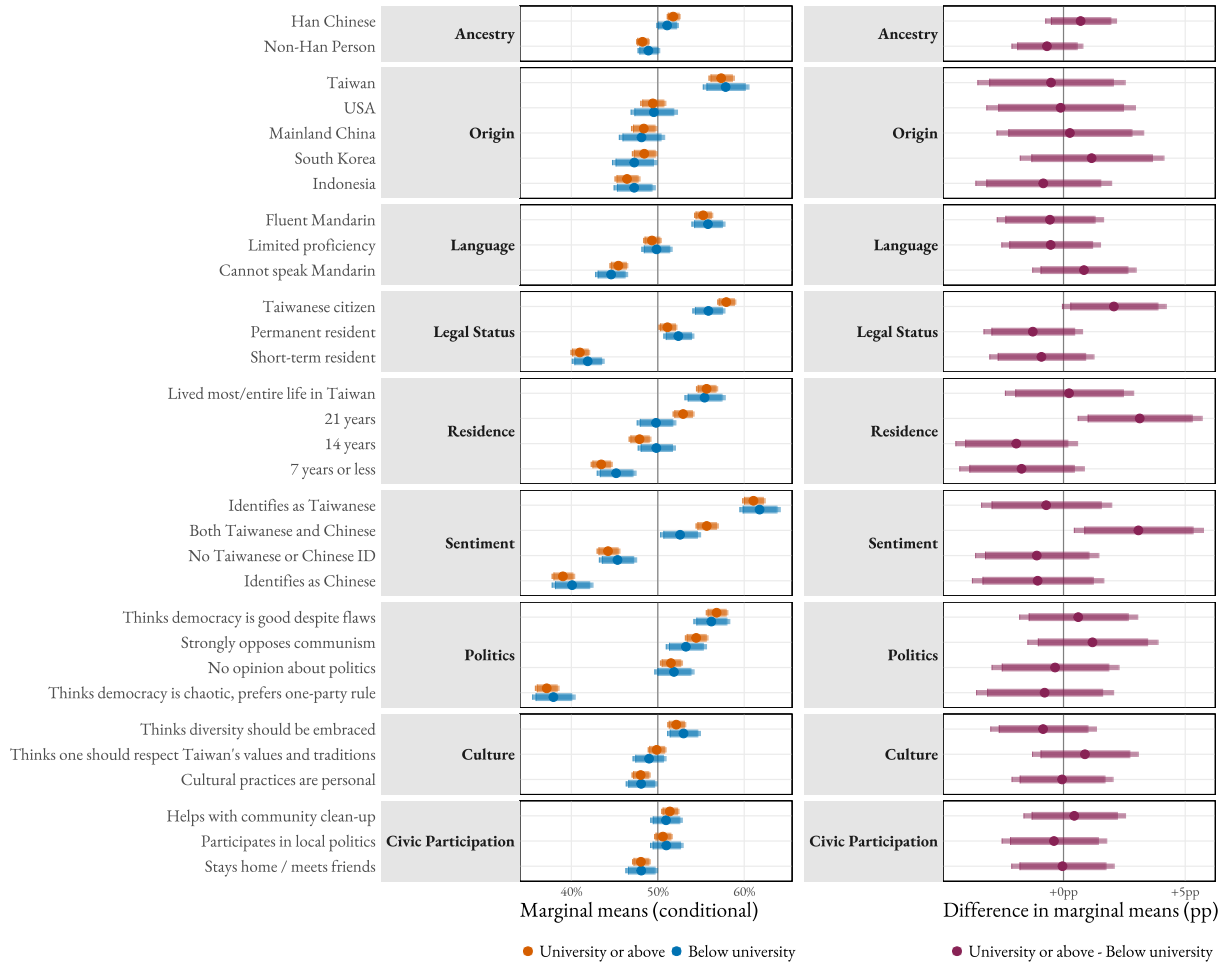


Figure D.2: Subgroup analysis by education level (university or above vs. below university).

Note: Left: conditional marginal means. Right: differences in marginal means (university minus below). Dual confidence intervals shown (thick: 90%; thin: 95%).

D.3 Gender

Figure D.3 compares male and female respondents. Gender differences in national identity have received limited attention in the Taiwan context, making this an exploratory analysis.

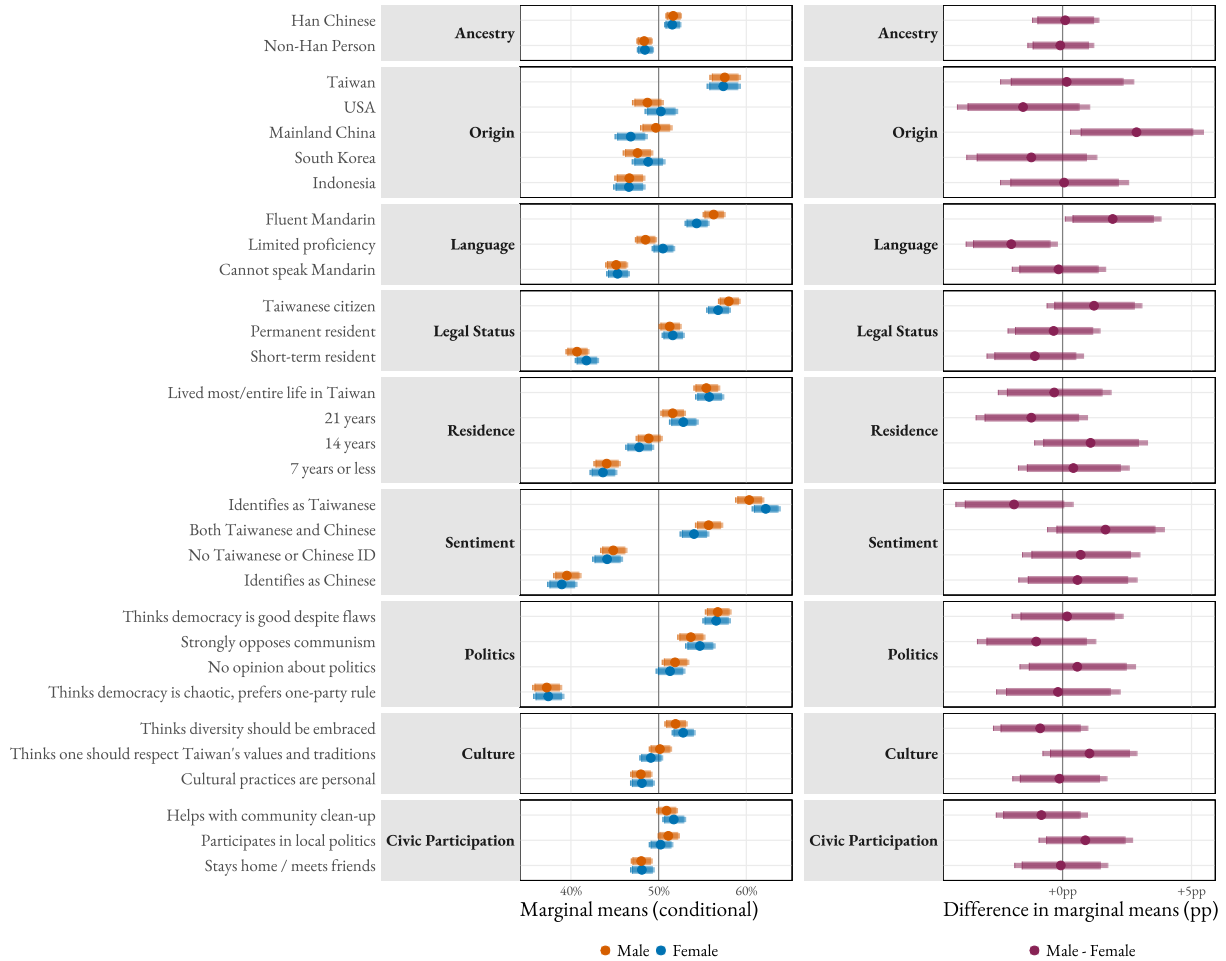


Figure D.3: Subgroup analysis by gender.

Note: Left: conditional marginal means for male vs. female respondents. Right: differences in marginal means (male minus female). Dual confidence intervals shown (thick: 90%; thin: 95%).

D.4 Partisanship (Pan-Green vs. Pan-Blue)

Figure D.4 compares respondents who identify with pan-Green parties (DPP, NPP, Green Party, TSU) with those who identify with pan-Blue parties (KMT, PFP, New Party), following the standard camp-level operationalization (Yu, 2017). Supporters of the Taiwan People's Party (TPP) and nonpartisans are excluded, as these respondents do not map cleanly onto either camp.

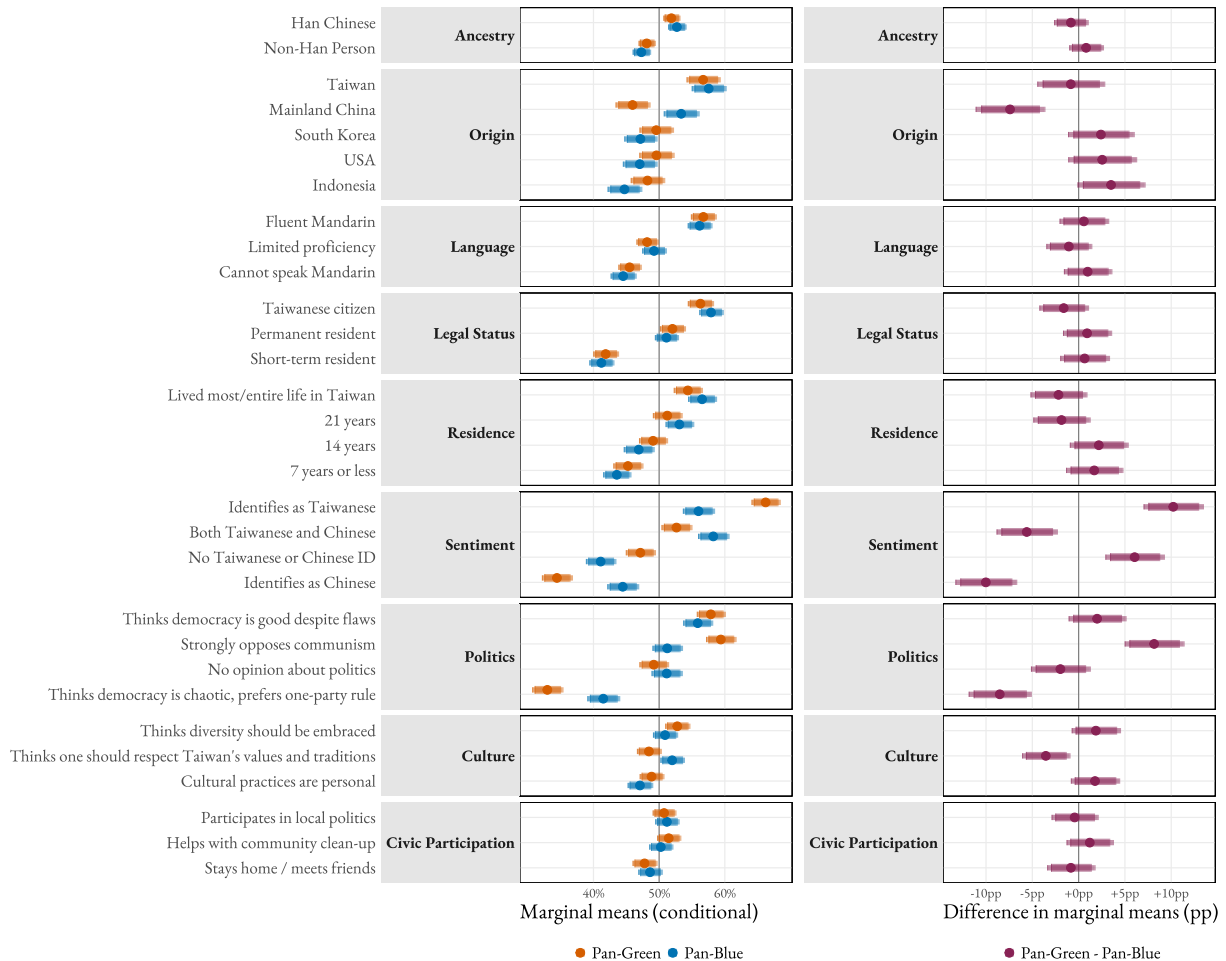


Figure D.4: Subgroup analysis by partisan camp (pan-Green vs. pan-Blue; TPP and nonpartisans excluded).

Note: Left: conditional marginal means. Right: differences in marginal means (pan-Green minus pan-Blue). Dual confidence intervals shown (thick: 90%; thin: 95%).

D.5 Liberal-Democratic Values (Procedural Robustness)

Figure D.5 repeats the subgroup analysis using respondents' position on the liberal-democratic values index, splitting at the 75th percentile. The purpose is to address the minben caveat introduced in the main paper: respondents who place high weight on the conjoint's "supports democracy" attribute could be doing so under either a procedural or a minben understanding. Respondents in the high lib-dem group are precisely those whose endorsement of democratic governance is unambiguously procedural and rights-based, so we expect the procedural reading to come through more sharply in their conjoint responses. The clearest signature of that reading is aversion to the openly anti-democratic option: high lib-dem respondents rate "thinks democracy is chaotic, prefers one-party rule" about 5.7pp lower than low lib-dem respondents, the largest political-level gap and one that survives Benjamini-Hochberg correction (SI §F). High lib-dem respondents also rate "strongly opposes communism" about 4.0pp higher, also surviving correction. The procedural-positive level ("thinks democracy is good despite flaws") does not separate the groups significantly, consistent with both groups treating it as the modal positive option and consistent with the procedural-vs.-minben distinction running through rejection of anti-democratic alternatives rather than embrace of a procedural-positive label.

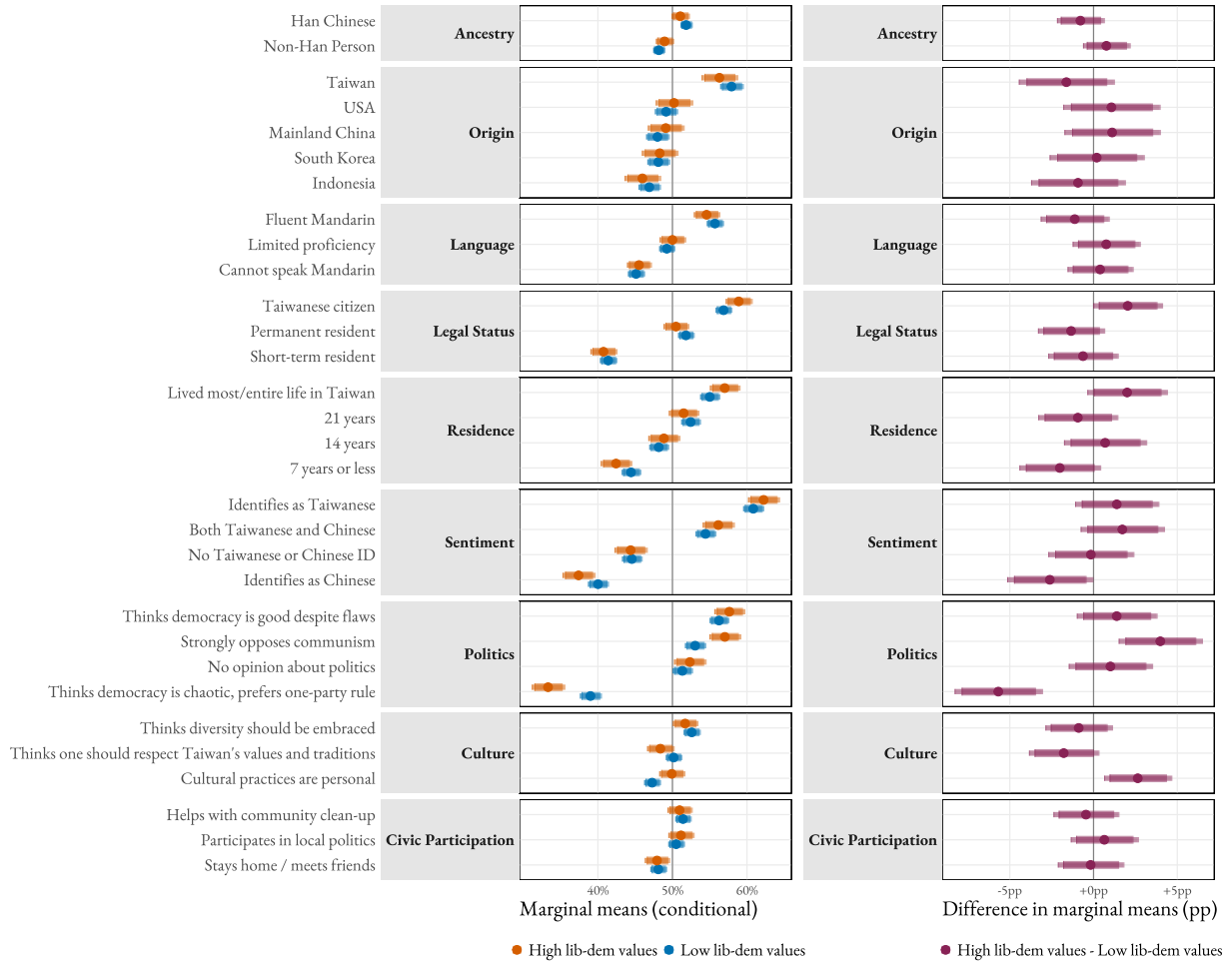


Figure D.5: Subgroup analysis by liberal-democratic values.

Note: Left: conditional marginal means for high vs. low lib-dem respondents (above vs. below the 75th percentile). Right: differences in marginal means. Dual confidence intervals shown (thick: 90%; thin: 95%). $n = 2,050$.

D.6 Interaction Analysis: Conditional Marginal Means in the Both-Pinned Cell

The main-text discussion of Section ?? (Figure ??) holds Non-Han ancestry fixed and stacks voluntarist and civic markers on top. A more restrictive specification additionally pins origin at Mainland China, the level that received the lowest marginal mean in the full-sample CBC #2 analysis. Figure D.6 estimates marginal means for the remaining seven attributes in this both-pinned cell, and Table D.1 reports the underlying values.

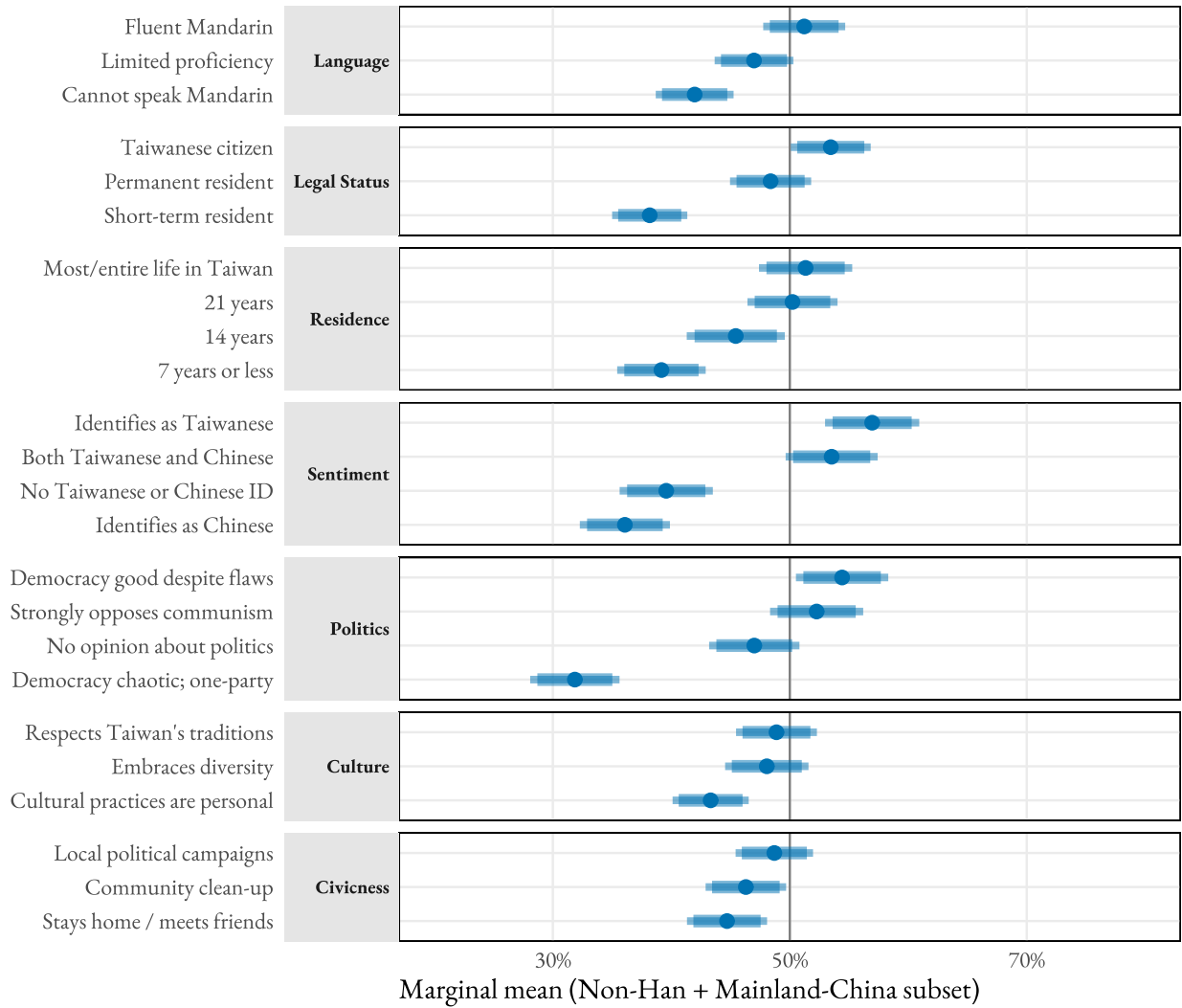


Figure D.6: Conditional marginal means for CBC #2 attributes in the Non-Han + Mainland-China subset.

Note: Marginal means estimated on the subset of tasks where ancestry is held at Non-Han and origin at Mainland China ($n_{\text{tasks}} = 2,445$; $n_{\text{resp}} = 1,457$). Dual confidence intervals shown (thick: 90%; thin: 95%). The vertical line at 0.5 marks parity with the alternative profile. Voluntarist and civic levels with marginal means above 0.5 are chosen at rates above chance even though the two ascriptive attributes are pinned to the values that received the lowest marginal means in the full-sample analysis.

Attribute	Level	Marginal mean (%)	95% CI (%)
Language	Fluent Mandarin	51.2	(47.8, 54.7)
	Limited proficiency	47.0	(43.7, 50.3)
	Cannot speak Mandarin	42.0	(38.7, 45.3)
Legal Status	Taiwanese citizen	53.5	(50.1, 56.8)
	Permanent resident	48.4	(45.0, 51.8)
	Short-term resident	38.2	(35.0, 41.3)
Residence	Most/entire life in Taiwan	51.3	(47.4, 55.3)
	21 years	50.2	(46.4, 54.0)
	14 years	45.4	(41.3, 49.6)
	7 years or less	39.2	(35.4, 42.9)
Sentiment	Identifies as Taiwanese	57.0	(53.0, 60.9)
	Both Taiwanese and Chinese	53.5	(49.7, 57.4)
	No Taiwanese or Chinese ID	39.6	(35.6, 43.5)
	Identifies as Chinese	36.1	(32.3, 39.9)
Politics	Democracy good despite flaws	54.4	(50.5, 58.3)
	Strongly opposes communism	52.3	(48.3, 56.2)
	No opinion about politics	47.0	(43.2, 50.8)
	Democracy chaotic; one-party	31.9	(28.1, 35.6)
Culture	Respects Taiwan’s traditions	48.9	(45.5, 52.3)
	Embraces diversity	48.1	(44.5, 51.6)
	Cultural practices are personal	43.3	(40.1, 46.5)
Civicness	Local political campaigns	48.7	(45.4, 52.0)
	Community clean-up	46.3	(42.9, 49.7)
	Stays home / meets friends	44.7	(41.3, 48.1)

Table D.1: Conditional marginal means for CBC #2 attribute levels in the Non-Han + Mainland-China subset.

Note: Estimated on the subset of tasks where ancestry is held at Non-Han and origin at Mainland China ($n_{\text{tasks}} = 2,445$; $n_{\text{resp}} = 1,457$). 95% confidence intervals from the design-based estimator.

D.7 Decomposing the Ascriptive Pin

Figure D.6 above holds both ascriptive markers (ancestry and origin) at their lowest-MM values. Ethnicity and birthplace carry partly distinct political valence, so we decompose the analysis into three panels. The left panel holds only Non-Han ancestry fixed and lets origin vary across all five birthplace categories. The middle panel holds only Mainland-China origin fixed and lets ancestry vary. The right panel holds both fixed, replicating Figure D.6.

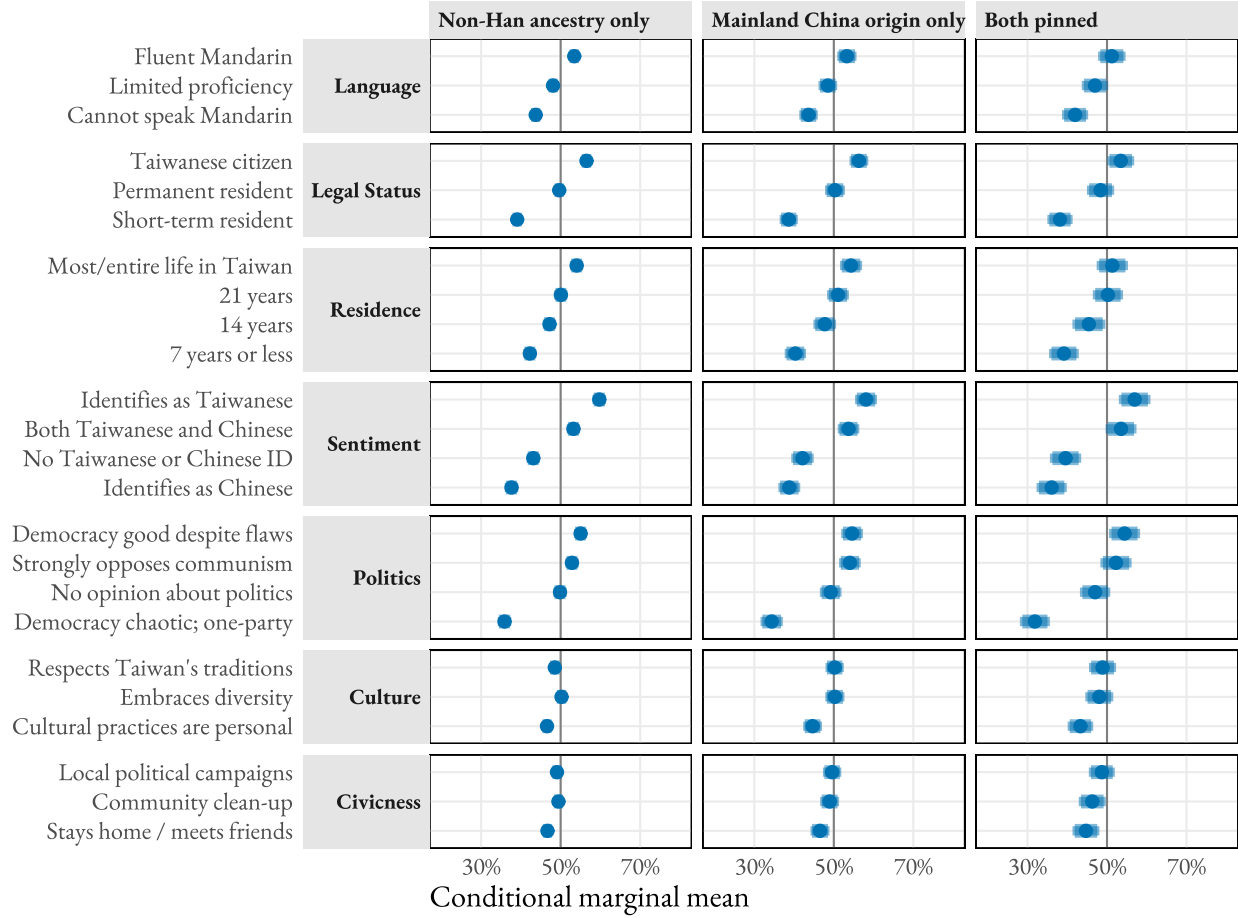


Figure D.7: Conditional marginal means for CBC #2 attributes by ascriptive pin (three panels).

Note: Left: Ancestry pinned to Non-Han Person, Origin random ($n_{\text{tasks}} = 12,336$; $n_{\text{resp}} = 2,049$). Middle: Origin pinned to Mainland China, Ancestry random ($n_{\text{tasks}} = 4,868$; $n_{\text{resp}} = 1,897$). Right: Both pinned ($n_{\text{tasks}} = 2,445$; $n_{\text{resp}} = 1,457$). Dual confidence intervals shown (thick: 90%; thin: 95%). The pattern is broadly consistent across panels. Voluntarist and civic levels clear parity in all three pins, and the lifts are slightly smaller in the both-pinned panel where the ascriptive penalty is heaviest.

D.8 Joint Voluntarist and Civic Scenarios

Table D.2 reports the conditional marginal means plotted in Figure ?? of the main paper, organized by which ascriptive criterion is held fixed (Non-Han ancestry in the upper block, foreign-born in the lower block) and within each block by step-up scenario. The cells stack a voluntarist marker (identifies as Taiwanese) and a civic marker (supports democracy) on top of the held-fixed ascriptive criterion to test whether the two markers interact when bundled. The observed marginal mean in the triple-condition cell is slightly above the additive prediction implied by the two single-condition cells in both panels, con-

sistent with a small positive (super-additive) interaction. Bundling the two markers lifts the conditional marginal mean to roughly 17–18 percentage points above parity in either case.

Ascriptive criterion	Scenario	Marginal mean	95% CI	<i>n</i> tasks	<i>n</i> resp.
Non-Han ancestry	Ascriptive marker alone	0.484	[0.478, 0.490]	12336	2049
	+ supports democracy	0.550	[0.534, 0.567]	3139	1658
	+ identifies as Taiwanese	0.597	[0.580, 0.614]	3016	1619
	+ supports democracy + identifies as Taiwanese	0.671	[0.638, 0.705]	776	645
Foreign-born	Ascriptive marker alone	0.481	[0.478, 0.485]	19687	2050
	+ supports democracy	0.548	[0.536, 0.560]	5113	1937
	+ identifies as Taiwanese	0.598	[0.585, 0.611]	4960	1923
	+ supports democracy + identifies as Taiwanese	0.678	[0.652, 0.703]	1288	957

Table D.2: Conditional marginal means for stacked voluntarist and civic markers on the two most ascriptive criteria.

Note: Robust standard errors clustered on respondent. Confidence intervals at the 95% level. “Foreign-born” is defined as origin in any country other than Taiwan, pooling Mainland China, Indonesia, USA, and South Korea.

D.9 Taiwanese Identity Strength

Figure D.8 compares respondents who score at or above the 75th percentile on the Taiwanese identity strength slider (a score of 10 out of 10, $\approx 56\%$ of the sample) with those who score below. Strong identifiers place greater weight on identifying as Taiwanese, less on identifying as Chinese, and weight democratic political orientation more heavily; the substantive pattern parallels the identity-category split reported in the main text but uses intensity of national identification rather than a categorical cleavage.

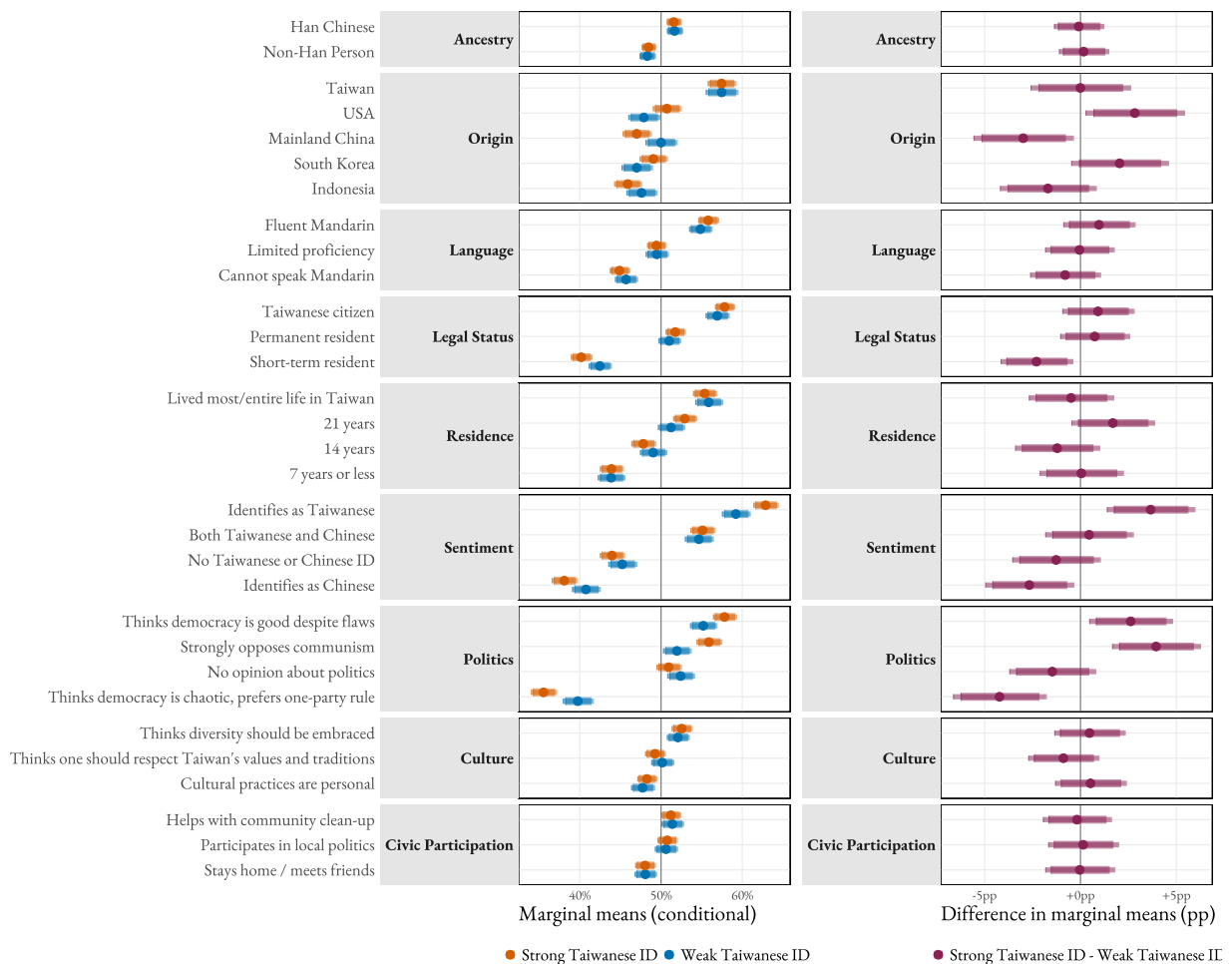


Figure D.8: Subgroup analysis by Taiwanese identity strength.

Note: Left: conditional marginal means for strong vs. weak Taiwanese identifiers (above vs. below the 75th percentile). Right: differences in marginal means (strong minus weak). Dual confidence intervals shown (thick: 90%; thin: 95%). $n = 2,050$.

E Measurement Error Correction

Conjoint estimates may be attenuated by measurement error when respondents answer inconsistently across tasks (Clayton et al., 2023). We estimate intra-respondent reliability (IRR) from our data using the extrapolation method of Clayton et al. (2023). For each respondent, we form all within-respondent pairs of conjoint tasks and compute the rate at which the respondent makes the same choice (selects the same profile number) across paired tasks, as a function of the number of attributes whose configurations differ between the two tasks. We then extrapolate this agreement rate to zero attribute differences via weighted least squares; the intercept estimates the IRR.

Figure E.1 shows the extrapolation for both conjoint experiments. CBC #1, with 8 binary attributes, provides better coverage at low difference levels. CBC #2, with 9 multi-level attributes, requires longer-range extrapolation because nearly all task pairs differ on many attributes simultaneously.

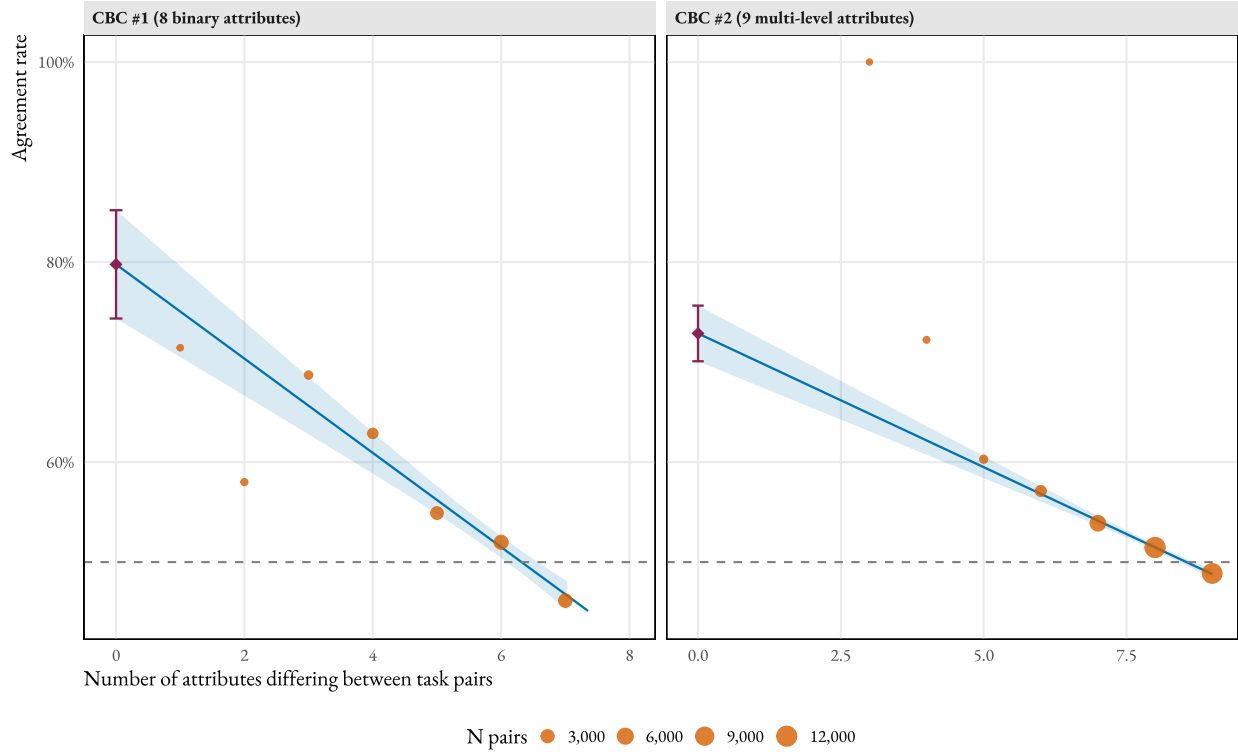


Figure E.1: Intra-responder reliability (IRR) estimation via the extrapolation method of Clayton et al. (2023).

Note: Points show observed agreement rates for task pairs grouped by number of differing attributes (sized by number of pairs). Line shows weighted least-squares fit with 95% confidence intervals. Diamond at $x = 0$ shows estimated IRR. Dashed line at 50% indicates random agreement.

Table E.1 reports uncorrected and bias-corrected AMCEs and marginal means for key attribute levels in CBC #2. The correction inflates estimates by a factor of $1/(1 - 2\tau)$, where τ is the error rate derived from the IRR. Corrected estimates are larger in absolute value, but the ranking of attributes and the substantive conclusions are unchanged.

Attribute	Level	AMCE	AMCE (corr.)	MM	MM (corr.)
Ancestry	Han Chinese	0.030	0.045	51.6%	52.4%
Language	Fluent Mandarin	0.101	0.149	55.4%	58.0%
Status	Permanent resident	0.103	0.152	51.4%	52.1%
	Taiwanese citizen	0.161	0.238	57.4%	61.0%
Residence	Lived most/entire life in Taiwan	0.118	0.174	55.6%	58.3%
Sentiment	Identifies as both Taiwanese and Chinese	0.103	0.152	54.9%	57.3%
	Identifies as Chinese	-0.053	-0.078	39.3%	34.1%
	Identifies as Taiwanese	0.167	0.246	61.2%	66.6%
Politics	Strongly opposes communism	0.027	0.040	54.2%	56.1%
	Thinks democracy is chaotic, prefers one-party rule	-0.142	-0.211	37.3%	31.3%
	Thinks democracy is good despite flaws	0.053	0.079	56.7%	59.8%
Culture	Thinks one should respect Taiwan's values and traditions	0.012	0.018	49.7%	49.5%
Civicness	Participates in local politics	0.027	0.040	50.7%	51.0%

Table E.1: Uncorrected and bias-corrected AMCEs and marginal means for key CBC #2 attribute levels.

Note: Correction follows Clayton et al. (2023). Sensitivity at assumed IRR = 0.70: correction factor = 1.58; at 0.75, 1.41; at 0.80, 1.29.

F Benjamini-Hochberg FDR Correction

The subgroup analyses estimate differences in marginal means for all attribute levels across two moderating variables (identity strength and liberal-democratic values), yielding a large number of simultaneous hypothesis tests. Following Liu and Shiraito (2023), we apply the Benjamini-Hochberg procedure to control the false discovery rate (FDR) at 0.05 across all diff-in-MM tests from both subgroup analyses jointly. Table F.1 reports the uncorrected and BH-corrected p -values for all estimates that are significant at $p < 0.05$ before correction, along with whether they survive correction. The same patterns also recur across additional subgroup comparisons (partisanship, identity category), providing informal replication that further supports the robustness of the findings.

Subgroup	Attribute	Level	Diff-in-MM	p	p_{BH}	Survives
Identity strength	Sentiment	Identifies as Chinese	-0.094	0.0000	0.0000	Yes
	Sentiment	Identifies as Taiwanese	0.091	0.0000	0.0000	Yes
	Sentiment	No Taiwanese or Chinese ID	0.067	0.0000	0.0000	Yes
	Politics	Strongly opposes communism	0.065	0.0000	0.0000	Yes
	Sentiment	Both Taiwanese and Chinese	-0.064	0.0000	0.0000	Yes
	Origin	Mainland China	-0.057	0.0000	0.0004	Yes
	Politics	Thinks democracy is chaotic, prefers one-party rule	-0.048	0.0003	0.0022	Yes
	Politics	No opinion about politics	-0.042	0.0009	0.0059	Yes
	Ancestry	Non-Han Person	0.016	0.0232	0.1197	No
	Ancestry	Han Chinese	-0.016	0.0253	0.1206	No
	Origin	Indonesia	0.027	0.0494	0.1898	No
Lib-dem values	Politics	Thinks democracy is chaotic, prefers one-party rule	-0.057	0.0000	0.0002	Yes
	Politics	Strongly opposes communism	0.040	0.0017	0.0104	Yes
	Culture	Cultural practices are personal	0.026	0.0099	0.0560	No
	Sentiment	Identifies as Chinese	-0.026	0.0445	0.1898	No

Table F.1: Benjamini-Hochberg FDR correction for diff-in-MM estimates.

Note: Shows all estimates significant at $p < 0.05$ before correction, with BH-corrected p -values and survival status at $FDR < 0.05$.

G Effective Sample Sizes

Table G.1 reports the number of unique respondents and effective observations (respondents $\times$ tasks) for each subgroup. Following Stefanelli and Lukac (2020), subgroups with fewer than 3,000 effective observations may be subject to elevated Type S (sign) and Type M (magnitude) errors and should be interpreted with caution.

Subgroup Variable	Group	<i>N</i> Respondents	Tasks	Effective <i>N</i>
Full sample	—	2,050	6	12,300
Identity strength	Weak Taiwanese ID	902	6	5,412
	Strong Taiwanese ID	1,148	6	6,888
Lib-dem values	Low lib-dem values	1,466	6	8,796
	High lib-dem values	584	6	3,504
Waishengren	Benshengren	1,727	6	10,362
	Waishengren	287	6	1,722†
Education	Below university	492	6	2,952†
	University or above	1,558	6	9,348
Gender	Female	962	6	5,772
	Male	1,088	6	6,528
Partisanship	Pan-Blue	509	6	3,054
	Pan-Green	505	6	3,030
Identity category	Both	664	6	3,984
	Taiwanese only	1,265	6	7,590

Table G.1: Effective sample sizes by subgroup for CBC #2 (six tasks per respondent).

Note: † indicates subgroups with effective $N < 3,000$, where statistical power may be insufficient for reliable subgroup comparisons (Stefanelli and Lukac, 2020).

H ISSP 2023 Benchmark Comparison

To assess whether our 2024 observational battery tracks an established cross-national benchmark, we compare it to the official ISSP 2023 National Identity and Citizenship module (ISSP Research Group, 2026). The ISSP 2023 wave (study ZA10010) was administered in 29 countries by the ISSP Research Group and archived at the GESIS Data Archive in Cologne (DOI 10.4232/5.ZA10010.1.0.0). The Taiwan sample ($n = 1,563$) was fielded in 2023–2024 by the Taiwan ISSP team, with 94% of interviews administered via computer-assisted personal interviewing (CAPI) with visuals and the remainder via paper-based modes. Respondents rated the importance of identity criteria for being “truly Taiwanese” on the same four-point scale (“very,” “fairly,” “not very,” “not at all important”) used in our 2024 instrument. We apply the official combined weights (WEIGHT_COM) when computing ISSP percentages.

The 2023 ISSP module fields six battery items, of which five overlap directly with our nine-item battery: born in country, citizenship, respect for political institutions, feels [Taiwanese], and ancestry. The ISSP item on religion has no analogue in our instrument; our four extra items (Mandarin proficiency, Taiwanese-language proficiency, knowledge of history and traditions, residence) extend the canonical battery with Taiwan-specific content. Figure H.1 reports the proportion of respondents rating each overlapping item as “very” or “fairly”/“quite” important.

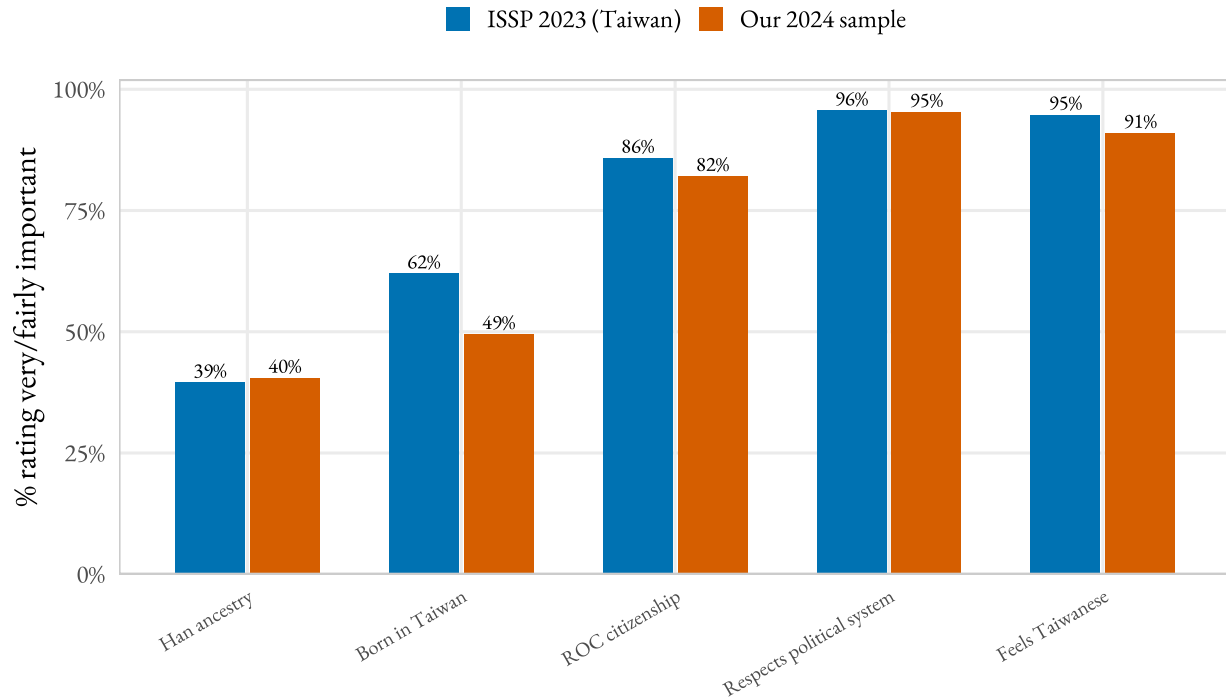


Figure H.1: ISSP 2023 Taiwan benchmark vs. our 2024 sample on overlapping observational battery items.

Note: Bars show the percentage of respondents rating each item as “very” or “fairly”/“quite” important for being truly Taiwanese. ISSP percentages use WEIGHT_COM ($n = 1,563$); our 2024 percentages are unweighted (quota-matched sample, $n = 2,050$). ISSP source: ISSP Research Group (2026).

The two batteries produce a consistent ranking: respect for political institutions and feels Taiwanese rank highest (95.6% and 94.7% in ISSP, 95.3% and 90.9% in our sample), followed by ROC citizenship (85.8% and 82.1%), birthplace (62.0% and 49.5%), and Han ancestry (39.5% and 40.4%). Level differences are within five percentage points for four of the five overlapping items, with the largest gap on “born in Taiwan.” These deviations are most plausibly attributable to differences in fieldwork mode (CAPI for ISSP 2023; online panel for our 2024 instrument), the one-year gap, and minor wording differences in the Mandarin translations. The pattern of relative importance, which is the substantive quantity our paper relies on, is identical across the two instruments: voluntarist and civic items dominate, ascriptive items are secondary, and birthplace sits between the two. This consistency suggests that our observational battery captures the same underlying structure that the ISSP benchmark documents, while reinforcing the limitation that motivates the conjoint approach: both batteries compress most attributes into the

upper end of the importance scale and offer no information about how respondents would weigh these criteria against each other under forced choice.

Table H.1 reports the underlying percentages and unweighted sample sizes.

Item	ISSP 2023 %	Our 2024 %	ISSP 2023 <i>N</i>	Our 2024 <i>N</i>
Born in Taiwan	62.0	49.5	1,557	1,852
ROC citizenship	85.8	82.1	1,558	2,006
Respects political system	95.6	95.3	1,546	2,023
Feels Taiwanese	94.7	90.9	1,555	2,009
Han ancestry	39.5	40.4	1,550	1,738

Table H.1: ISSP 2023 Taiwan benchmark vs. our 2024 sample: percent rating each overlapping battery item “very” or “fairly”/“quite” important.

Note: ISSP percentages use WEIGHT_COM; our 2024 percentages are unweighted.

I Original Survey Wording (Chinese)

This appendix reproduces the original Mandarin Chinese wording for the observational battery, the two identity-strength sliders, the liberal-democratic values battery, and both conjoint tasks. English glosses are given in italics. Throughout the survey, the term “我國” (literally “our country”) was used in place of “Taiwanese” or “ROC” in question stems that asked about national membership. As noted in the main text, this country-neutral phrasing was chosen so that the criterion (membership) would not be conflated with the self-identification options (Taiwanese, Chinese, both) that respondents were also asked to choose among elsewhere in the survey. Item wording is drawn from the Qualtrics Survey File (QSF) for ROC Experiments 2023 (survey ID SV_9BMS4HMqRNUK1M).

Observational Identity Battery (Q15)

Stem. 有人說，成為一個我們真正的國民，以下幾點很重要。其他人則說這些不重要。您認為以下各選項有多重要？

Some people say that the following points are important for being a true national of our country. Others say these are not important. How important do you consider each of the following options?

Items. The instrument fields ten items. Item 7 (cultural norms) is excluded from analysis because it cross-loads on multiple factors. The nine items used in the paper appear below in survey order, and the excluded item is flagged.

1. 祖先是漢族 (*Han ancestry*)
2. 在台灣出生 (*born in Taiwan*)
3. 擁有中華民國（台灣）的國籍 (*holds ROC (Taiwan) nationality*)
4. 會說國語 (中文) (*speaks Mandarin Chinese*)
5. 會說台語（閩南話） (*speaks Taiwanese / Hokkien*)
6. 感覺自己是台灣人 (*feels Taiwanese*)
7. 遵循台灣的文化規範 (*follows Taiwan's cultural norms*) — *excluded from analysis*
8. 尊重台灣的政治制度和法律 (*respects Taiwan's political system and laws*)
9. 了解台灣的歷史與傳統 (*knows Taiwan's history and traditions*)
10. 一生中大部分時間都居住在台灣 (*has lived most of life in Taiwan*)

Response scale. Four points, ordered from least to most important.

- 非常不重要 (*very unimportant*)
- 不太重要 (*not very important*)
- 相當重要 (*quite important*)
- 非常重要 (*very important*)

Identity-Strength Sliders (Q11_1, Q12_1)

Taiwanese identity (Q11_1). 請您用 0 至 10 分來表示您自認為是台灣人的程度，0 分表示「完全不是台灣人」，10 分表示「完全是台灣人」。請問您會選幾分？

Please rate, on a 0–10 scale, the degree to which you consider yourself Taiwanese. 0 means “not at all Taiwanese,” 10 means “completely Taiwanese.” What score would you choose?

Chinese identity (Q12_1). 請您用 0 至 10 分來表示您自認為是中國人的程度，0 分表示「完全不是中國人」，10 分表示「完全是中國人」。請問您會選幾分？

Please rate, on a 0–10 scale, the degree to which you consider yourself Chinese. 0 means “not at all Chinese,” 10 means “completely Chinese.” What score would you choose?

Liberal-Democratic Values Battery (Q24)

Stem. 還有一些關於政治的敘述。請您評估一下每個敘述。

Here are some additional statements about politics. Please evaluate each statement.

Items. Item 3 (the one liberal-direction statement, asking whether respondents with low education should have an equal political voice) is inverse-coded prior to summation so that every item points in the illiberal direction; the total is then reflected so that higher index values indicate stronger liberal-democratic commitment.

1. 女性不應該像男性那樣參與政治。 *Women should not participate in politics the way men do.*
2. 政府在解釋法律時應諮詢宗教機構。 *The government should consult religious institutions when interpreting the law.*
3. 受教育程度低或沒有受過教育的人應該與受過高等教育的人一樣在政治上有發言權。
People with low or no education should have an equal political voice as those with higher education.
(inverse-coded)
4. 政府領導人就像一家之主，我們都應該遵從他們的決定。 *Government leaders are like the head of a household, and we should all follow their decisions.*
5. 政府應該決定是否允許某些意見想法在社會上討論。 *The government should decide whether certain opinions and ideas may be discussed in society.*

6. 如果人們組織很多政治團體，社區的和諧就會被破壞。 *Community harmony would be undermined if people organized many political groups.*
7. 法官在審理重大案件時，應聽取行政機關的意見。 *When judging important cases, judges should listen to the executive branch.*
8. 如果政府不斷受到立法機關的審查和監督，就無法成就大事。 *If the government is constantly scrutinized and supervised by the legislature, it cannot accomplish great things.*
9. 如果我們有道德高尚的政治領導人，我們就可以讓他們決定一切。 *If we have morally upright political leaders, we can let them decide everything.*
10. 如果人們有太多不同的意見與想法，社會就會變得混亂。 *If people have too many different opinions and ideas, society would become chaotic.*
11. 當國家面臨困境時，政府可以不顧法律來應對局面。 *When the country faces difficulties, the government may set aside the law to respond.*

CBC #1 Conjoint Task (Binary Design)

Task stem. 要成為我國真正的國民需要具備一些條件或滿足一些情況，有些條件很重要，有些則不重要。下面是兩個人的簡介及其特點。請仔細閱讀兩個人的簡介，並從這兩個人中選出您心目中我國真正的國民。

Becoming a true national of our country requires meeting certain conditions or fulfilling certain circumstances. Some conditions are important, and others are not. Below are profiles of two people and their characteristics. Please read each profile carefully and choose, between the two, the one you consider to be a true national of our country.

Choice question. 請選擇哪一個人更像是我國國民。

Please select which person is more like a national of our country.

Attributes and levels. Eight attributes, each with two levels. The levels reproduced below are the original Mandarin from the survey-randomization JavaScript embedded in the QSF.

出生地 (**Origin**) 在台灣出生 (*born in Taiwan*) | 不在台灣出生 (*not born in Taiwan*)

居住地 (**Residence**) 一生中大部分時間都居住在台灣 (*has lived most of life in Taiwan*) | 多數或全部時間都不居住在台灣 (*has lived most or all of life outside Taiwan*)

民族 (**Ethnicity**) 漢人 (*Han*) | 非漢人 (*non-Han*)

公民身分 (**Citizenship**) 中華民國國民 (*ROC national*) | 非中華民國國民 (*not an ROC national*)

對歷史和傳統的看法 (**View of history and traditions**) 了解台灣的歷史與傳統 (*knows Taiwan's history and traditions*) | 對台灣的歷史與傳統不太了解 (*does not know much about Taiwan's history and traditions*)

對政治制度和法律的看法 (**View of political system and laws**) 尊重台灣的政治制度與法律 (*respects Taiwan's political system and laws*) | 對台灣的政治制度和法律缺乏興趣或了解 (*lacks interest in or understanding of Taiwan's political system and laws*)

語言能力 (**Language ability**) 會說國語 (中文) (*speaks Mandarin*) | 不會說國語 (中文) (*does not speak Mandarin*)

民族情懷 (**National sentiment**) 感覺自己是台灣人 (*feels Taiwanese*) | 不覺得自己是台灣人 (*does not feel Taiwanese*)

CBC #2 Conjoint Task (Multi-Level Design)

Task stem. 在定義國家認同時，人們優先考量不同的價值觀和信念。以下為您呈現兩個在台灣生活的人的簡介，每個人都有獨特的特質和信念。請查看每份個人資料並選擇您認為是我國國民的人。如果您不確定自己比較想選哪個人，也請務必選擇一個。

In defining national identity, people prioritize different values and beliefs. Below are profiles of two people living in Taiwan, each with distinctive characteristics and beliefs. Please look at each profile and choose the one you consider to be a national of our country. If you are unsure which one you would prefer, please still select one.

Choice question. 請選擇哪一個人更像是我國國民。

Please select which person is more like a national of our country.

Attributes and levels. Nine attributes with two to five levels each.

出生國 (**Country of birth**) 台灣 (*Taiwan*) | 中國大陸 (*Mainland China*) | 印尼 (*Indonesia*) | 美國 (*USA*) | 南韓 (*South Korea*)

種族 (**Ethnicity**) 漢人 (*Han*) | 非漢人 (*non-Han*)

法律地位 (**Legal status**) 臨時居民 (*short-term resident*) | 永久居民 (*permanent resident*) | 台灣公民 (*Taiwanese citizen*)

在台灣居住的時間 (**Time lived in Taiwan**) 7 年 (含) 及以下 (*7 years or less*) | 14 年 (*14 years*) | 21 年 (*21 years*) | 大部分時間或一生 (*most of life or whole life*)

對政治制度的看法 (**View of the political system**) 對政治制度沒有意見 (*no opinion on the political system*) | 認為民主儘管有缺陷，但仍是好制度 (*thinks democracy is a good system despite its flaws*) | 強烈反對共產主義 (*strongly opposes communism*) | 認為民主太混亂，更喜歡一黨威權統治 (*thinks democracy is too chaotic and prefers single-party authoritarian rule*)

國語能力 (**Mandarin proficiency**) 國語 (中文) 流利 (*fluent Mandarin*) | 國語 (中文) 能力有限 (*limited Mandarin*) | 不會說國語 (中文) (*does not speak Mandarin*)

國家認同 (**National identification**) 認為自己是台灣人 (*identifies as Taiwanese*) | 認為自己是中國人 (*identifies as Chinese*) | 認為自己既是台灣人也是中國人 (*identifies as both Taiwanese and Chinese*) | 認為自己既不是台灣人也不是中國人 (*identifies as neither Taiwanese nor Chinese*)

對文化和價值觀的看法 (**View of culture and values**) 認為人們的文化習俗和信仰是私事，社會不應將特定的價值觀或傳統強加於任何人 (*thinks cultural practices and beliefs are private matters and society should not impose particular values or traditions on anyone*) | 認為要真正屬於這個國家，維護和尊重我們共同的傳統和價值觀很重要 (*thinks it is important to uphold and respect shared traditions and values to truly belong to the country*) | 相信我們的社會因其居民的多元文化、傳統和價值觀而變得豐富，我們應該接納這種多樣性 (*believes society*

is enriched by the diverse cultures, traditions, and values of its residents, and we should embrace that diversity)

公民參與 (**Civic engagement**) 閒暇時間待在家裡或跟朋友喝咖啡/茶 (*spends free time at home or having coffee/tea with friends*) | 幫助社區組織清掃活動 (*helps community-organized cleaning activities*) | 參與當地的政治活動 (*participates in local political activities*)

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